When can a prediction replace a physical trial? A production-referenced evaluation of design-stage decision rules in deep drawing

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Abstract

~~Design-stage manufacturability decisions rest increasingly on simulation~~ Simulation and machine learning inform design-stage manufacturability decisions, ~~whose fitness to decide is rarely evaluated against production~~yet they are judged by prediction error, not by whether their verdicts could replace a physical trial. ~~The proposed framework's~~ This paper proposes a production-referenced evaluation of design-stage decision rules. Its unit, the ~~production~~ within-run floor, is the difference that drift and scatter of production and measurement produce between two batches of one design within a run. For each evidence relation of a new design to produced ~~evidence~~ones (a sibling, a new process setting or a new family), a rule ~~returning~~ that returns meets, fails or trial ~~has a~~ is characterised by its decisive distance~~in floors~~, beyond which at least 95 % of its verdicts are correct, and ~~a~~ its safe distance, beyond which at most 5 % are wrong; a ~~procedure adds~~ guard ~~bands for~~ band turns them into single verdicts. ~~Fourteen rules were evaluated at 95 % conformance on open data of 18 deep-drawn alternatives of 500 parts, mostly~~ An exploratory application to one laboratory deep-drawing process~~settings~~, with ~~matched simulations (a draw-in floor: 0.05 mm). With a~~ alternatives produced ~~sibling~~once and an uncalibrated simulation dataset, ~~the~~ scored simulation-based, learned and production-record rules. The nearest produced setting~~was right for requirements over~~, committed to in advance, decided at 3.4 floors ~~from the truth (near-replicates 0.85, resolvable siblings 4.9). For~~ with a sibling and 8.5 for a new process setting. No simulation-based or learned rule was more decisive; a Gaussian process specified for small data reduced to a force trend. Intervals calibrated on the ~~best rules needed 4.7 floors interpolating~~same relation in the other family, ~~4.9 extrapolating to 500 kN and 8.9 to 100 kN~~not learning, ~~with a stroke-speed change;~~ made the production record safe for new

settings. For a new family ~~the best was safe at 16–17~~ only simulation-based rules decided, none closer than 30 floors~~in either family's floor~~. ~~Requirements at~~ Within a ~~performance index of 1.33 lay inside every decisive distance except~~ family, a ~~near-replicate's. With six~~ production record indexed by its relation to ~~nine produced alternatives at two or three forces,~~ the ~~simulation as used, offset or rescaled, helped only across families; learned 90 % intervals covered 85–96 % with~~ coming design is the baseline a ~~sibling, under 50 % extrapolating or across families. This gives AI-based~~ learned manufacturability ~~support a production-referenced evaluation standard~~check has to beat.

Keywords: decision support, design for manufacturing, machine learning, uncertainty quantification, selective prediction, deep drawing

1 Introduction

Whether a design alternative can be made to its requirements is decided long before it is made. In sheet-metal forming the decision rests on a finite-element simulation (Banabic, 2010): the team compares the predicted characteristics with the requirements and releases the alternative, changes it or sends it to a physical trial. ~~Simulation has moved such decisions forward (Thomke, 1998), and artificial intelligence makes the~~ Artificial intelligence makes this loop faster: surrogates replace simulations, models learn manufacturability from earlier and synthetic designs ~~, checks are automated (Yan et al, 2026; Ghadai et al, 2018; Zhang et al, 2018; Ballegeer and Benoit, 2026)~~ (Yan et al, 2026; Ghadai et al, 2018; Ballegeer and Benoit, 2026), and predictive-quality models and virtual metrology estimate ~~product~~ quality from process data (Tercan and Meisen, 2022; Dreyfus et al, 2022). Such models are judged by their prediction error on held-out data, which leaves open the question the team has to answer: *can this prediction be relied on to decide, or is a trial still needed?* Mechanical design cannot be verified by simulation the way integrated circuits are (Whitney, 1996), and ~~production variation, with which development organisations still contend (Thornton et al, 2000), adds a further reason: whether a prediction-based decision is credible is a property of production , and production evidence is scarce at the design stage.~~

~~This paper treats the design-stage manufacturability decision itself as the object of study~~the answer depends on how much production has been seen and how the new design relates to it.

Uncertainty quantification supplies intervals (Nemani et al, 2023), and virtual metrology attaches a reliance index to each prediction (Cheng et al, 2008), but neither says how close to a requirement a verdict can be relied on, in a unit that production defines, for each relation of a new design to the produced evidence. This paper asks three questions. How can the fitness of a design-stage prediction to decide be expressed on a ~~common~~ production-referenced scale, for any predictor and characteristic (RQ1)? How does it depend on the amount of production evidence and on how the new design relates to ~~what has been produced~~ it (RQ2)? And~~what do simulation and machine learning contribute once production evidence~~

~~exists~~ , with six to nine produced alternatives, what do a generic simulation dataset, Gaussian processes, gradient boosting and calibrated intervals contribute against a production-record baseline (RQ3)? ~~Uncertainty quantification for machine learning supplies intervals (Nemani et al, 2023), but AI-based decision support, decision-based design (Hazelrigg, 1998), design margins (Eckert et al, 2019) and test planning (Thomke and Bell, 2001; Salado and Kannan, 2018; Tahera et al, 2019) need to know how close to a requirement a prediction can be relied on.~~

The ~~framework proposed here has the~~ proposed framework has the ~~*production*~~ *within-run floor* as its unit: the difference that drift and scatter of production and measurement produce between two batches of one design within a run~~, a floor in the sense of a noise floor~~. A rule that turns the design-stage evidence into a verdict (*meets*, *fails* or a physical *trial*) is ~~characterised~~scored, for each *evidence relation* between a new design and the produced alternatives, by two points on its operating ~~characteristics in floors~~characteristic, its *decisive* and *safe distances*~~, and~~ ; a procedure turns them into a guard band for single verdicts and prices them by the costs of errors and trials. The decisions in scope are those of process planning, the approval of process changes in series production and the qualification of AI-based tools that would take part in them, for a team that has produced variants of a design family~~, in process planning and tryout and when production knowledge is carried to a new family~~; the tryout of a new die, in which the tool itself changes between loops, is not.

The ~~evaluation~~ application uses open data: 9,000 deep-drawn and cut cups of dual-phase steel, produced as 18 design–process alternatives of 500 consecutive parts each on one laboratory tool set (Baum and Heinzelmann, 2026), with finite-element simulations of the same process ~~(Baum and Heinzelmann, 2025). Within each of two cup geometries the alternatives differ in blank-holder force and lubrication on one tool, so two of the three relations concern process settings, and the geometries give two transfers between families. Each alternative is judged as a new design by fourteen rules at a 95 % conformance level, against what its 500 parts did~~from a generic dataset (Baum and Heinzelmann, 2025). Each alternative was produced once, and the simulations were not calibrated to the process. The study is exploratory: it shows whether the framework discriminates between rules and evidence situations ~~, not whether design teams decide better with it~~on real data, and its findings ~~on one dataset~~ are hypotheses for confirmation. The contributions are the framework (Section 3)~~, ~~; an evaluation design that separates evidence relations~~and ~~ , isolates what the simulation adds and tests the learners against a production-record baseline (Section 4)~~, empirical answers for deep drawing~~ ; findings for this process (Section 5)~~, and guidance and a reporting standard for evaluating simulation- and AI-based manufacturability support, including classifiers and language-model checks~~ ; and a proposed reporting checklist with an open scoring function (Section ~~6~~6.4).

2 Background and related work

2.1 Machine learning for manufacturability, predictive quality and virtual metrology

Design for manufacturing ~~(DFM)~~ codifies what a process can make into rules ~~,~~ ~~guidelines~~ and cost models (Boothroyd et al, 2010)~~, and quantitative manufacturability models have long driven design decisions (La Trobe-Bateman and Wild, 2003). Machine~~ ; machine learning learns manufacturability from CAD models (Ghadai et al, 2018; Zhang et al, 2018), ~~also from~~ synthetic sheet-metal datasets (Ballegeer and Benoit, 2026), ~~from~~ process data and simulated design spaces (Yan et al, 2026)~~, and generative models propose designs directly (Regenwetter et al, 2022)~~. In production, predictive-quality models and virtual metrology estimate quality from process data (Wuest et al, 2016; Tercan and Meisen, 2022; Dreyfus et al, 2022)~~, their reproducibility and reuse have become research questions (Xie et al, 2025, 2026) , and for deep drawing, ~~ ; their uncertainty is quantified by Bayesian, ensemble and conformal methods (Nemani et al, 2023; Heddoub et al, 2026). Automatic virtual metrology goes further and attaches to every prediction a reliance index and a global similarity index that flags process data unlike the training data (Cheng et al, 2008, 2012), the closest analogue in this literature to the guard band and the applicability guards of this paper. Models are carried across products and processes by transfer learning and domain adaptation (Maschler and Weyrich, 2021) , also from simulation to real parts (Tercan et al, 2018). In sheet forming, machine learning predicts defects and springback from simulated and measured data (Cao et al, 2024; Heinzelmann et al, 2025b), and discrepancies between synthetic and real data are being addressed for ~~AI applications (Baum et al, 2026b). Learned~~ deep drawing (Baum et al, 2026b). These models are evaluated by held-out accuracy ~~on labelled designs or parts~~or coverage, and language ~~and vision-language~~ models by case studies (Makatura et al, 2024) and ~~benchmark questions~~ benchmarks (Picard et al, 2025), not by the decisions they ~~support~~ would take against the production of the alternatives they are asked about.

~~Decision-based design casts design as a choice between alternatives with uncertain outcomes (Hazelrigg, 1998). How much a team knows about a new alternative depends on the kind of design, variant, adaptive or original (Pahl et al, 2007), organised across products by platform design (Simpson et al, 2006); the evidence relations of this paper are their counterparts for production evidence, the design type concerning the novelty of the solution and the evidence relation the novelty of its realisation relative to what has been produced. Production knowledge enters design through process-capability data (Thornton, 2004; Tata and Thornton, 1999). Unresolved uncertainty is absorbed by margins (Eckert et al, 2019), whose part that covers uncertainty is distinct from the part that absorbs change (Eckert and Isaksson, 2017). Tests and prototypes, the alternative to a margin, are modelled as a trade between the costs of tests and of errors (Thomke, 1998; Thomke and Bell, 2001; Salado and Kannan, 2018) and studied as design activities (Tahera et al, 2019). When upstream information is fit to act on is the question of overlapped development (Krishnan et al, 1997; Terwiesch et al, 2002) , and set-based concurrent engineering codifies production knowledge as feasibility~~

limits (Sobek et al, 1999). All of these assume a measure of how far a design-stage prediction can be relied on; the framework supplies one in a unit set by production.

2.2 Simulation credibility and the validation of forming simulation

Verification and validation ask whether a model is accurate enough for its intended use; the distinction between its validation and application domains (Oberkampf and Roy, 2010)is the question that the evidence relation asks of a design, and risk-informed , distinguishing its validation from its application domain (Oberkampf and Roy, 2010); credibility assessment scales the required evidence with the consequence of a wrong decision (ASME, 2018). Bayesian calibration adds a discrepancy model and calibration parameters to a simulator (Kennedy and O'Hagan, 2001), estimates calibration parameters together with a model discrepancy (Kennedy and O'Hagan, 2001; Higdon et al, 2004) , without which calibrated parameters are biased and over-confident (Brynjarsdóttir and O'Hagan, 2014; Arendt et al, 2012); multi-fidelity models scale a cheap model to an expensive one (Kennedy and O'Hagan, 2000) , and a model may be relied on only within its valid input domain (Malak and Paredis, 2010). Conformal prediction gives distribution-free intervals under exchangeability (Lei et al, 2018; Barber et al, 2021), also under covariate shift (Tibshirani et al, 2019) and for decision risks (Angelopoulos et al, 2024), and have entered quality assurance (Heddoub et al, 2026) and engineering design (Zong et al, 2026). In sheet-metal forming, friction (Hol et al, 2012) and the unloading behaviour of combine a cheap and an expensive model through a fitted scale and a discrepancy (Kennedy and O'Hagan, 2000; Le Gratiet and Garnier, 2014) . In sheet forming, the friction law (Hol et al, 2012), the unloading and hardening behaviour that govern springback (Yoshida and Uemori, 2002; Wagoner et al, 2013) and the elastic deflection of the tools (Pilthammar et al, 2018) are the material (Yoshida and Uemori, 2002) are main sources of simulation error, simulation datasets of deep drawing ; robustness analysis propagates the scatter of material and process inputs (Wiebenga et al, 2014; Chen et al, 2022), and draw-in is measured and controlled in line in series production (Havinga et al, 2020; Fischer et al, 2018). Datasets of deep-drawing simulations support surrogate and transfer learning (Baum and Heinzelmann, 2025; Heinzelmann et al, 2025a), and the deviation between simulation and parts has been decomposed statistically (Baum et al, 2026a). How ; how close to a requirement such intervals and accuracy statements a calibrated or learned prediction can be relied on to decide , and how much production evidence that takes, remains open.

2.3 Decisions with abstention and their evaluation

In conformity assessment a measured value proves conformance, proves non-conformance or leaves the decision open, with guard bands set by the measurement uncertainty and the risks of false acceptance and rejection as the measures of a decision rule (ISO, 2017). In selection procedures and acceptance sampling (ISO, 2017)

; the global consumer's and producer's risks follow from a prior distribution of the measurand (Joint Committee for Guides in Metrology, 2012). In acceptance sampling and selection procedures the operating characteristic gives the probability of a decision against the true quality, with an indifference zone inside which no decision is required (Bechhofer, 1954). A classifier with a reject option trades errors against abstentions (Chow, 1970; Geifman and El-Yaniv, 2017), as does regression with a reject option (Zaoui et al, 2020); learning to defer passes difficult cases to an expert (Madras et al, 2018). Cost-sensitive evaluation (Elkan, 2001) and decision curves (Vickers and Elkin, 2006) price the errors, and appropriate reliance on automation requires that its reliability be visible to its users (Lee and See, 2004), ~~also in design teams working with AI (Zhang et al, 2021)~~though displayed confidence can calibrate trust without improving joint accuracy (Zhang et al, 2020, 2021). The decisive and safe distances are operating characteristics of this kind, and the ~~procedure's~~ guard band is the design-stage counterpart of a conformity-assessment one, whose dependence on a prior of requirement distances mirrors that of the global risks.

2.4 Production variation, measurement and design decisions

Statistical quality control compares short- and long-term variation with tolerances through capability and performance indices~~(Montgomery, 2019), with release criteria such as a performance index of at least~~ , with recommended minima for existing processes (Montgomery, 2019); in an initial process study an index above 1.67 meets the acceptance criteria and one between 1.33 ~~(Automotive Industry Action Group, 2006)~~ and 1.67 may be acceptable after a review by the customer (Automotive Industry Action Group, 2006), and time-dependent models ~~for~~ describe drifting processes (ISO, 2026). Precision experiments define the repeatability limit, the difference that two results under repeatability conditions exceed with a probability of 5 % (ISO, 2025), and intermediate precision under conditions that differ in time ~~, operator or equipment~~ (ISO, 2023); measurement systems analysis separates repeatability from bias, linearity and stability (Automotive Industry Action Group, 2010). ~~The production floor is a precision limit of this kind for batch centres within a run (Section 3.2); what is new is its use not to judge whether two results agree but as the unit in which a design decision rule is scored and its guard band set.~~ In engineering design, decisions between alternatives with uncertain outcomes (Hazelrigg, 1998) are taken with margins (Eckert et al, 2019) or with tests whose cost is traded against that of errors (Thomke and Bell, 2001; Salado and Kannan, 2018), and what a team knows about a new alternative depends on whether it is a variant, an adaptation or an original design (Pahl et al, 2007), of which the evidence relations are the counterparts for production evidence.

Table 1 places the framework among ~~them: it does not replace calibration or conformal prediction but scores them as decision rules against production in a common unit~~these methods. It adopts the indifference zone of operating characteristics, the guard band of conformity assessment, the selective risk of abstaining predictors and grouped cross-validation (Roberts et al, 2017). What is new is the production-defined unit in which every rule and characteristic is scored, the qualification by evidence

Table 1 Positioning among methods that support or evaluate design-stage manufacturability decisions

Approach	Evidence	Output	Scored against production	Abstains
DFM rules and cost models (Boothroyd et al, 2010)	codified process knowledge	guideline compliance, cost	no	no
V&V, credibility assessment (Oberkampf and Roy, 2010; ASME, 2018)	physics model, validation tests	accuracy; required evidence	on test cases	can require tests
Bayesian calibration (Kennedy and O'Hagan, 2001)	simulations, experiments	predictive distribution	not as decisions	implicitly
Conformal prediction (Lei et al, 2018)	exchangeable calibration data	interval with coverage	coverage	yes
Virtual metrology with reliance index (Cheng et al, 2008)	process data of produced items	value, reliance and similarity index	on held-out production	flags
Conformity assessment, OC curves (ISO, 2017; Bechhofer, 1954)	measurement and its uncertainty	accept, reject, undecided; risks	on the measured item	yes
Selective classification and regression (Chow, 1970; Zaoui et al, 2020)	labelled data	value or reject; risk–coverage	on held-out data	yes
ML manufacturability models (Ghadai et al, 2018; Yan et al, 2026)	historical or simulated designs	class or value	on held-out data	rarely
This paper	simulations, produced alternatives	verdict; distances in floors by evidence relation	yes, per verdict	yes

relation, and their combination into a procedure for design-stage decisions that any predictor can enter.

3 The framework

3.1 The decision problem, its scope and its loss

A design alternative a is a combination of product geometry and process settings produced as a series of parts, over which a quality characteristic c varies. A requirement is an upper limit R on the characteristic, or on its absolute value for characteristics whose target is zero, that a share p of the parts must meet: alternative a is *adequate* for c when the p-quantile of its parts satisfies $q_p(a, c) \leq R$. ~~Lower or two-sided limits follow by a change of sign or by the absolute deviation from the target.~~ At the design stage q_p is unknown. A decision rule r maps the available evidence to an interval

$[L_r, U_r]$ for q_p and to a verdict

$$V_r = \begin{cases} \text{meets} & U_r \le R, \\ \text{fails} & L_r > R, \\ \text{trial} & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases} \tag{1}$$

The three verdicts mirror the decision rules of conformity assessment (ISO, 2017)~~, here for the uncertainty of a design-stage prediction~~. A rule that returns a point ($L_r = U_r$) always decides. The evidence consists of simulations of a and of the production record of other alternatives, the *calibration alternatives*. The ~~demonstration decides on~~ verdict costs c_{FA} when a failing alternative is accepted, c_{FR} when an adequate one is rejected and c_{T} when it is sent to trial, so a rule's expected cost per verdict is

$$C = c_{\mathrm{FA}} P_{\mathrm{FA}} + c_{\mathrm{FR}} P_{\mathrm{FR}} + c_{\mathrm{T}} P_{\mathrm{T}}, \tag{2}$$

which the two distances of Section 3.4 summarise at a fixed share of errors. Three limits of scope apply: the demonstration uses upper limits on the 95th percentile ($p = 0.95$, ~~which~~ for a normal characteristic ~~corresponds to~~ a performance index of about 0.55~~. Release criteria of series production, a performance index of 1.33 or more (Automotive Industry Action Group, 2006), concern nonconforming fractions in parts per million that a series of 500 parts cannot estimate without a parametric tail; Section ?? locates such limits relative to the distances, without deciding them~~), lower limits following by a change of sign; verdicts are per characteristic, a design-level verdict over all characteristics being reported as an extension (Section 5.7); and attribute outcomes such as splits and wrinkles, which need a requirement on a rate, are not covered.

3.2 The within-run floor

Production evidence comes as series of consecutive parts, each cut into batches of B consecutive parts ~~, and each batch is~~ summarised by a robust centre m (here the 10 % trimmed mean). The ~~production~~ within-run floor of characteristic c, the floor for short, is

$$F_c = Q_\alpha\{\, |m_i - m_j| : i < j \text{ batches of the same alternative} \,\}, \tag{3}$$

the α-quantile of the difference between two batches of one design. Under a stationary normal model with a standard deviation σ_{b} between batch means and σ_{w} between parts, $F_c = 1.96\sqrt{2}\sqrt{\sigma_{\mathrm{b}}^2 + \sigma_{\mathrm{w}}^2/B}$ at $\alpha = 0.95$, the form of the repeatability limit ~~of precision experiments (ISO, 2025). Because~~ (ISO, 2025, 1994); because it pools batch pairs up to 450 parts apart and grows with their lag~~(Section 5.1)~~, it is closer to a time-different intermediate-precision limit (ISO, 2023) of batch centres within a run~~; in the terms of ISO 22514-2 the runs follow a time-dependent model with varying location (ISO, 2026)~~. The reference protocol ~~of this paper~~ is $B = 50$, ten batches of a 500-part run, all pairs of batches and $\alpha = 0.95$~~, with per-geometry floors where~~

~~geometries differ~~; every characteristic is scored in the floor of its own geometry, and the pooled floor serves only to convert distances to physical units. The floor rests on three assumptions: batches of one design differ only by drift and scatter within a run (A1); the variation within the runs from which it is estimated is like that within future runs (A2); and the measuring system is repeatable and its ~~measurement~~ resolution small against the floor (A3~~, checked in Section 5.1~~).

Four properties matter for its use. It has the unit of the characteristic, so distances in floors ~~are on a common scale for~~ put all characteristics and predictors on a common scale, though equal distances do not mean equal nonconforming fractions~~(Table 4)~~. It is a property of a protocol~~: under drift it grows with the time between the batches compared and shrinks with B~~, and σ_{b} and σ_{w} are reported so that it can be recomputed. It contains whatever drifts between batches, process and measuring system alike~~, so~~ : without a reference artefact scanned through the series it is a production-and-measurement floor, and not the shop floor. And it excludes the variation between runs, which makes it a lower bound of the variation of series production. A new family, whose floor is unknown before it is produced, is scored in the floor of the produced family~~, and because the floor resolves batch centres, the reproducibility of the decided quantile is reported alongside.~~

. Two alternatives a and b are resolvable for c when their effect-to-scatter ratio

$$\mathrm{ESR}_c(a,b) = |\bar{m}_a - \bar{m}_b| \,/\, F_c$$

$\mathrm{ESR}_c(a,b) = |\bar{m}_a - \bar{m}_b|/F_c$ is at least one, $\bar{m}$ being the centre of all parts of an alternative; ~~this is a practical threshold, not a test. For a continuous design or process~~ for a continuous parameter x with ~~a local sensitivity $s_c = \partial\bar{m}/\partial x$,~~ local sensitivity $s_c = \partial\bar{m}/\partial x$ the minimum resolvable change is $F_c/|s_c|$~~: a change of x by less moves the centre of the characteristic by less than two batches of one design differ. It is local and concerns centres; a change below it can still move the tail~~.

3.3 Decision rules

~~Fourteen rules span what a design team can do with its evidence~~ Eight rules carry the main results (Table 2); ~~the first seven and the force trend M1sn carry the main results. Beside the nominal simulation s_0~~ ten further rules, with and without the simulation, are defined in Appendix A. The nominal simulation (M0) ~~, the bias-corrected simulation (M1) adds the median offset between the calibration alternatives' q_p and their s_0; the~~ is the simulation at nominal sheet thickness and friction. The scaled simulation (M1s) fits $q_p = a + b\,s_0$ to ~~them~~ the calibration alternatives by least squares, ~~a linear~~ the scale term of a multi-fidelity correction ~~(Kennedy and O'Hagan, 2000)~~without its discrepancy. The envelope rule (M2) adds the median offset ~~and the largest absolute residual~~ of the calibration alternatives ~~to the upper end~~ and their largest absolute residual to the top of the simulation envelope over ~~plausible incoming conditions, which vary sheet thickness and friction but not material properties.~~ the dataset's thicknesses and friction coefficients. The GP-corrected envelope (M5) models the offset between q_p and the envelope as a Gaussian process (Rasmussen and Williams, 2006) ~~with a 90 % predictive interval, whose~~

noise variance is fitted by maximum marginal likelihood, its noise variance bounded below by the variance between the calibration alternatives' series of one geometry and force , so that a new series of a produced setting is not predicted more precisely than produced series reproduce each other; M5n is the same process of q_p without the simulation(the noise-variance bound). The nearest produced setting (NN) is the mean q_p of the calibration alternatives at the nearest force, a capability-database look-upthat uses neither simulation nor learning. The seven further rules include a friction-calibrated simulation (Kennedy and O'Hagan, 2001) (Mc), part-level gradient boosting (Friedman, 2001) with a jackknife+ interval (Barber et al, 2021), with and without the simulation (M3, M3n) , and and the force trend (M1sn) the least-squares line of q_p in force(M1sn). The nominal simulation and the envelope do not depend on the lubrication pattern, so , the counterpart of M1s without the simulation, which within a geometry they are functions is a function of the forcealone: M1sn is the counterpart of M1s without the simulation, and a lubrication variant gives M0, M1, M1s, M2 and M5 no simulated information that distinguishes it from its siblings. .

With n calibration alternatives, the largest-residual margin covers a new exchangeable residual with probability $n/(n+1)$ for a fixed offset and at least $(n-1)/(n+1)$ for an estimated one; it is the split-conformal quantile (Lei et al, 2018) at the highest attainable level, not a The trend GP (M7n) is a learner specified for six to nine produced alternatives: a Gaussian process of q_p with a linear mean in force and lubrication whose coefficients are integrated out (universal kriging), weakly informative priors on length scales and noise instead of hard bounds, and a noise term made of the known sampling variance of each q_p and an estimated between-run nugget that absorbs no modelled effect. Its counterpart with the simulation (M7) is the autoregressive multi-fidelity model (Kennedy and O'Hagan, 2000), with the simulation in the mean and a GP discrepancy. Finally, intervals are separated from predictors: P+RM puts around the point prediction of a rule P a relation-matched interval, the 90% interval. A distribution-free interval cannot certify a miss rate below $1/(n+1)$, so a miss rate of 5% needs at least 19 produced alternatives in split-conformal quantile (Lei et al, 2018) of P's absolute errors in floors over the cases of the relevant relation. With six to nine calibration alternatives the jackknifesame evidence relation in the other family, a group-conditional construction (Vovk et al, 2005). The residuals are borrowed because a family's own calibration set holds no case of its new-setting relation; they guarantee coverage only if the two families' errors are exchangeable, which the data cannot establish (Barber et al, 2023). NN+bounds at the level of 0.9 fall at or beyond the extreme leave-one-out values, which are used instead; under exchangeability these guarantee a coverage of $1-2/(n+1)$, 0.71 to 0.80 (Barber et al, 2021), approximately because the residuals are centred on their median. The Gaussian-process interval is model-based. The level trades decisiveness for safety, as the cost of errors would set the threshold of a reject option (Chow, 1970); 0.9 is used here, 0.8 and 0.95 in the robustness analysisRM is the production-record baseline with such an interval.

Table 2 The rules of the main results; ten further rules are defined in Table A2

Rule	Prediction of q_p	Interval (level)	Evidence
M0 nominal simulation	simulation at nominal thickness and friction	point	none
M1s scaled simulation†	$a + b$ M0, least squares	point	q_p
M2 envelope + residual margin	envelope top plus the median offset	largest residual ($\frac{n-1}{n+1}$)	q_p
M5 GP-corrected envelope	envelope plus a GP offset, ML-II	GP (nominal 0.9)	q_p
NN nearest produced setting†	mean q_p at the nearest produced force	point	q_p
M1sn force trend†	$a + b$ force, least squares	point	q_p
M7n trend GP‡	linear mean plus GP, MAP under priors	GP (nominal 0.9)	q_p
NN+RM‡	NN	relation-matched (0.9)	q_p

Fitted on the calibration alternatives~~. Descriptors~~; descriptors: geometry indicator, blank-holder force and lubrication rank~~(the order of the oil amount)~~. ~~GP~~Pre-specified unless marked: ~~Gaussian process. M3 and M3n at part level; M3n is named M4 in~~ † added after the ~~released code~~first results; ‡ added for this version. ~~M6~~Levels: guaranteed (largest residual, n calibration alternatives: 8 with a ~~conformalised GP~~sibling, ~~is~~ 6 for a ~~robustness variant (Table 5~~new setting, 9 for a new family) or nominal.

3.4 Operating characteristics: decisive and safe distances

A rule is scored by judging each produced alternative as a new design at requirements placed at a known distance from the truth,

$$R = q_p(a, c) + d\,F_c, \tag{4}$$

so that a is adequate exactly when $d \geq 0$. ~~For a case (a, c) with interval $[L, U]$, let $u = (U - q_p)/F_c$ and $v = (q_p - L)/F_c$ be the distances by which the interval excludes the truth from above and below. At $d = +\delta$ the verdict is correct when $u \leq \delta$ and a false reject when $-v > \delta$; at $d = -\delta$ it is correct when $v < \delta$ and a false accept when $-u \geq \delta$.~~ Let $\kappa(\delta)$ and $\omega(\delta)$ be the shares of correct and of wrong verdicts among all feasible verdicts at $|d| = \delta$: every case gives one verdict on an adequate alternative and, where ~~$q_p - \delta F_c \geq 0$~~the requirement is not negative, one on a failing alternative~~, and every verdict has equal weight. As δ grows, failing-side requirements become infeasible for characteristics close to zero, so the failing side carries half the weight up to a few floors and a third at about 100 floors (98 of 126 failing-side requirements remain feasible at 16 floors and 63 at 108)~~. The *decisive distance* δ_d ~~of a rule~~ is the smallest δ beyond which $\kappa \geq 0.95$, and ~~its~~ the *safe distance* δ_s the smallest δ beyond which $\omega \leq 0.05$ ~~.~~

~~The distances are exact up to the 0.05-floor grid on which they are evaluated: κ and ω change only where δ crosses one of the case's u, v, $-u$ or $-v$, so the distances are order statistics of these exclusion distances;~~ (Fig. 1a). In plain terms, for a rule that always decides, $\delta_\mathrm{d} = \delta_\mathrm{s}$ is close to the ~~90 % quantile~~ 90th percentile of its absolute error in floors~~. Always $\delta_\mathrm{s} \leq \delta_\mathrm{d}$~~; an interval rule trades decisiveness for safety, and between ~~the two the rule~~ δ_s and δ_d it sends designs to trial rather than misleading~~;~~

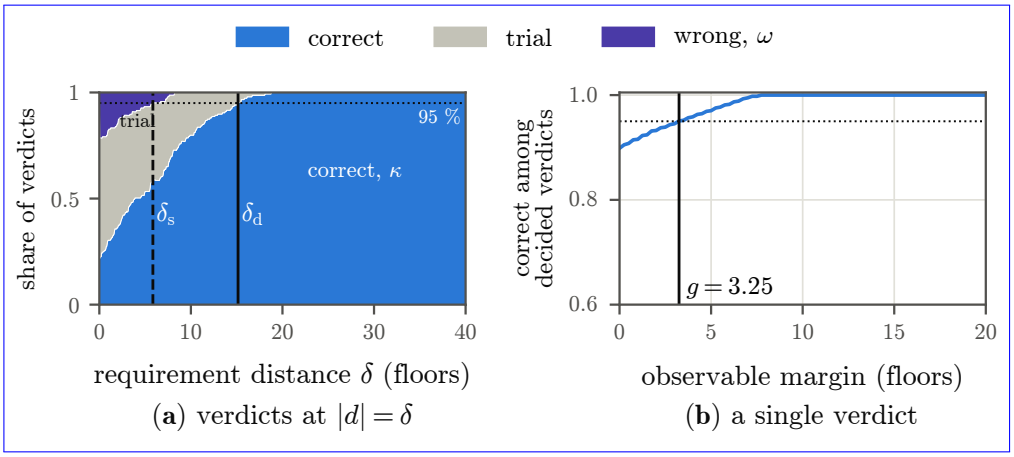


Fig. 1 Operating characteristics of one rule (M7n, extrapolated setting): verdict shares against the requirement distance, with δ_d and δ_s (a), and correct share among decided verdicts against the margin, with g (b)

~~one-sided distances for failing alternatives (false accepts) and adequate ones (false rejects) matter when the errors cost differently. The distances~~ . Both are points on operating characteristics over a population of design situations~~:~~; δ_d is the analogue of the indifference zone of a selection procedure (Bechhofer, 1954) at a probability of correct selection of 0.95. ~~A trial is not error-free: a short run reproduces the 95th percentile~~

The distances are exact up to the 0.05-floor grid on which they are evaluated, because κ and ω change only where δ crosses the distance by which a case's interval excludes its truth. They are order statistics, so a few verdicts far out can move them: with 126 cases, some 240 verdicts, the 95 % threshold rests on about a dozen. Distances below about one floor are reported as "<1", since production reproduces the decided quantile only to about one floor within a run (Section 5.1)~~and, being a run, also carries the variation between runs, so no decision is reliable closer to the requirement than the trial replacing it~~. The distances weigh false accepts and false rejects equally, and as δ grows, failing-side requirements become infeasible for characteristics close to zero, so the failing side carries half the weight up to a few floors and a third at about 100 floors; the safe distances on the false-accept and the false-reject side are therefore reported as well.

3.5 Evidence relation and calibration budget

How a new design relates to the produced alternatives is part of the decision situation. With a *sibling*, an alternative at the same process setting has been produced that differs only in the factor varied at a fixed setting (here the lubrication pattern~~), which production may not resolve~~, which the nominal simulation does not represent); a *new process setting* lies between produced settings (interpolation) or outside them (extrapolation); a *new family* shares no produced alternative. A team knows, before it decides, whether the produced siblings of a new variant differ resolvably from each other, so the sibling relation is stratified by this decision-time information, not by the

new design's own production. The calibration budget is the dependence of the distances on the number k of produced alternatives~~, over all subsets of size k classified by relation~~. An applicability guard flags a ~~new design that lies~~ design outside the calibration, in the spirit of a valid input domain (Malak and Paredis, 2010): its geometry is not calibrated~~(family guard)~~, a descriptor lies outside the calibrated range~~(range guard)~~, or its simulated q_p lies outside that of the calibration alternatives'~~ simulated values (novelty guard), in the spirit of a valid input domain (Malak and Paredis, 2010)~~ .

3.6 Procedure

Figure 2 turns the framework into six steps~~:~~, steps 1 to 5 once per design family ~~,~~and repeated when production evidence is added, and step 6 for every new design. Steps 1 to 4 frame the decision (family, alternatives, characteristics, form of the requirement, ~~conformance level~~costs), measure the floor with a stated protocol, state which differences production resolves, and calibrate the candidate rules with and without the simulation.

Step 5 qualifies ~~them~~ the rules of the family by their distances for each evidence relation and fixes for each rule and relation a *guard band* g: the smallest observable margin between the predicted interval and the requirement beyond which at least 95 % of the decided verdicts ~~were~~ are correct. Being conditional on what is observed, g depends on the distribution of requirement distances that the team expects, ~~not on rule and relation alone~~its prior, as the global risks of conformity assessment do (Joint Committee for Guides in Metrology, 2012). The reference prior weights the 47 distances of the ~~requirement~~ evaluation grid within ±20 floors equally (0, ±0.5 to ±10 in steps of 0.5, ±12, ±15~~and~~ , ±20~~; 87 % of the weight within ±10), drops infeasible requirements and searches g in steps of 0.25 floors up to 20, beyond which the rules send most designs within the prior's range to trial; it is a reference for requirements set from~~), requirements set a few to some tens of floors from the true 95th percentile ~~, denser where verdicts are hardest, which~~ (±20 floors are about ±1 mm of mid-side draw-in, ±1.6° of wall angle, ±0.2 mm of cup depth and ±0.07–0.16 mm of dome); a release-like prior, the grid within ±5 floors, stands for requirements near capability limits, and a team replaces both by the distribution of its own requirements~~.~~, for example the margins between past drawing limits and achieved 95th percentiles. The band is estimated per family and validated out of sample, leaving out one alternative and, for new settings, one force cell.

Step 6 establishes the relation of the new design, applies the rule qualified for it, widens the rule's interval by g floors and returns meets or fails with the margin in floors, or a trial when no rule is qualified or the requirement lies inside the widened interval. ~~The guard~~ In pseudocode, step 5 is: for each rule and relation, collect the held-out verdicts over the prior; for $g = 0, 0.25, \ldots, 20$, compute the share correct among verdicts decided with a margin of at least g; take the smallest g beyond which it stays at or above 0.95. Step 6 is: $V =$ meets if $U + gF \le R$, fails if $L - gF > R$, trial otherwise. The band of the relation takes the place of the range and family guards, which here coincide with the extrapolated and new-family relations~~; the novelty guard~~

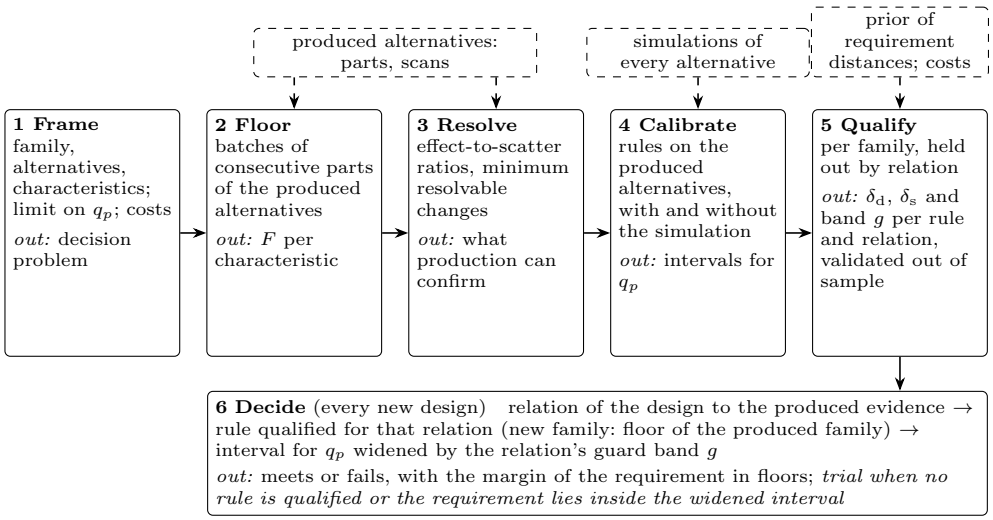


Fig. 2 The procedure: steps 1–5 once per design family, step 6 for every new design; dashed boxes are the evidence and inputs it uses

~~is reported as a diagnostic, not applied, since most of its refusals would have been right; Section 5.5 reports g under other priors and works one decision through.~~ .

3.7 A worked example

A process planner has to decide whether the concave cup can be run at 300 kN with medium lubrication, a setting not yet produced, without a trial run, the six alternatives at 100 and 500 kN having been produced. Step 1 frames the decision: the characteristic is the mid-side draw-in, by which the blank-holder force is set, the requirement (chosen for illustration) that 95 % of the parts draw in by at most 15.30 mm, and a trial costs a short press run, about a twentieth of a false accept. Step 2 gives the floor from the produced series, 0.050 mm, and step 3 shows that force changes of 21–67 kN are resolvable. Step 4 calibrates the rules on the six alternatives. Step 5 qualifies the nearest produced setting for interpolation: it decides at 4.7 floors and needs a guard band of 1.5 floors on this family (2.0 pooled over the families); out of sample, 95 % of its decided verdicts stayed correct. Step 6: the nearest setting, the mean of the six alternatives at the neighbouring forces, predicts 14.99 mm, a margin of 6.2 floors, more than its band, so the planner releases the setting. The trend GP agrees with a margin of 4.5 floors; M2, M5 and M5n, widened by their bands, contain the limit and would send the design to trial, and the nominal simulation, qualified for no relation, predicts 15.66 mm. The 500 parts had a 95th percentile of 14.88 mm, 8.4 floors below the limit.

4 Demonstration on deep drawing

4.1 Alternatives and production data

The production data are the Real Deep Drawing and Cutting dataset (RDDAC) of the University of Stuttgart (Baum and Heinzelmann, 2026; Baum et al, 2026a). Square blanks of DP600 dual-phase steel, 210 mm wide and about 1 mm thick, were deep drawn into cups (OP10) and cut (OP20) on an industrial press with one tool set~~with two~~, whose two die geometries, concave and convex side walls, ~~which~~ differ in base curvature, wall angle and bottom radius at once. Each geometry was run at three blank-holder forces (100, 300 and 500 kN) and three lubrication patterns applied to the blank (coarse, medium and fine, with series medians of 1.15–1.48, 0.92–1.23 and 0.85–1.13 g/m^2 of oil): 18 alternatives, each produced as one series of 500 consecutive parts ~~, the change of geometry being the only change of product design~~(their centres in Online Resource 1, Fig. S1). Every part has ~~press signals , sheet~~ the signals of four load cells around the die at 300 Hz, the punch position and temperature, sheet-thickness and oil-film traverses and ~~3D~~ laser scans after both operations. The series warm up by 1.0–5.0 K over their first 150 parts from punch temperatures of 20.5–29.6 °C, their median sheet thickness is 0.986–0.993 mm, and the 100 kN series ran at 47 mm/s against 78–79 mm/s~~. The~~ , so the extrapolation to 100 kN also changes the sliding speed and stroke rate on which the lubricant film depends. The experiments were collected between September and November 2025, in contiguous blocks of 500 per alternative; the documentation states neither the order ~~and dates of the series~~ of the blocks nor whether the parts were scanned in production order, and gives no material certificate, coil record, tool drawing, press or cushion type, or method of applying the lubrication patterns.

4.2 Simulations

The simulations come from the Deep Drawing and Cutting Simulations dataset (DDACS) (Baum and Heinzelmann, 2025; Heinzelmann et al, 2025a) , a generic dataset of some 32,000 LS-DYNA simulations of the same ~~group (Baum and Heinzelmann, 2025; Heinzelmann et al, 2025a): LS-DYNA quarter models with~~ cup family that was neither set up for nor validated against the produced process. Its documentation gives rigid tools (blank holder, die, punch), shell elements with seven integration points through the thickness and nodes about 1 mm apart, a scaled DP600 flow curve, constant Coulomb friction, a drawing depth of 30 mm, trimming in OP20 without modelled cutting tools, and springback after both operations; it leaves open the element formulation, whether contact accounts for the shell thickness, the yield criterion and ~~unloading model, which govern springback (Yoshida and Uemori, 2002), are not documented, and~~ hardening law, the blank-holder actuation and the springback procedure, and it does not represent the stroke speed~~is not represented~~. For the RDDAC tools, 396 simulations vary the sheet thickness (0.95–1.00 mm) and the friction coefficient (0.05–0.15) at each geometry and force, all with the nominal flow curve. A part is matched to the simulation with the nearest thickness and the friction coefficient that the dataset's linear mapping

assigns to its oil film, an assumption of the dataset's authors on which ~~Mc,~~ M3~~and every matched simulation~~, M3n and the matched simulations depend. The nominal simulation of an alternative is at 0.99 mm, the grid value nearest the median thickness, and friction 0.10, the middle of the grid; Mc and Mcd calibrate the friction coefficient instead.

4.3 Measurement and quality characteristics

The parts were measured with a single-sided laser line scanner, which records a height and a luminescence image of 3200 by 2000 points, 0.077 mm apart along the laser line (x) and 0.158 mm apart between lines in the direction of motion (y), with height steps of 7.75 µm, the cup bottom facing the scanner (Fig. 3). The scales are not traced to the part: the lateral one comes from the scanner specification and a 30 mm calibration block, the line spacing from the scans themselves, partly fitted to the simulation, and the height from a 1 mm block, against a nominal repeatability of 5 µm. Absolute values are therefore uncalibrated, which limits every absolute comparison with the simulation (Section 5.2) but not the floor, a within-alternative difference that a constant scale error changes only in proportion.

Seven characteristics were extracted with the same definitions from the scans and from the simulated nodes, referred to the plane of the cup bottom (Table 3): the mid-side and corner draw-in and the flange waviness, process indicators on the flange that the cut removes~~, and four characteristics a drawing would carry: ;~~ the wall angle ~~(design angle 20° concave, 10° convex),~~ and the cup depth, measured after drawing because the cut removes the flange that defines the depth and the cut walls facing the scanner read several degrees too steep; and the arm angle and bottom dome of the cut part, the last two with requirements on absolute values. The four sides of a part measure several of them twice, which exposes ~~the measurement~~direction-dependent systematic errors: the flange width ~~along~~ in the direction of motion (W_y) reads 2.3–3.5 mm larger than along the laser line (W_x) and scatters 3.7 to 17.6 times more, the ~~scan lines scatters 4 to 18 times morethan across them, so the mid-side draw-in is taken across the scan lines~~two flange diagonals differ by 1.6–2.2 mm, and the ~~wall angle is the mean of the east and west walls~~south wall, shadowed, reads 7–10° off. The directions kept avoid the worst of them, but their residual bias is unknown. The mid-side draw-in is quantised in steps of 0.019 mm (0.38 floors)~~by the pixel pitch. Differences between scans and simulations, such as the scanned surface against the shell mid-surface, enter the offsets between the two but not the floors~~, so that a series takes only 6 to 21 distinct values (Fig. 4).

4.4 Evaluation design

Every produced alternative is judged as a new design under grouped cross-validation (Roberts et al, 2017), one scheme per evidence relation. *New variant*: the alternative alone is held out and the other eight of its geometry calibrate, two siblings at its force among them. *New process setting*: the three alternatives of one force of a geometry are held out and the six others calibrate; 300 kN is interpolated, 100 and 500 kN

Table 3 The quality characteristics and their measurement by the laser scanner

Characteristic	Op.	Region; definition	Step/F	Values	Direction-dependent differences
Draw-in, mid-side	OP10	flange mid-sides; $(210 - W_x)/2$, W_x along the laser line	0.38	6–21	$W_y - W_x$ 2.29–3.47 mm; W_y, in the direction of motion, scatters 3.7–17.6 times more
Draw-in, corner	OP10	flange corners; mean of the two diagonals	<0.01	491–500	the two diagonals differ by 1.64–2.17 mm
Flange waviness	OP10	flange; residual SD about a quadratic surface	<0.01	469–494	–
Wall angle	OP10	side walls at mid-depth; mean of east and west	<0.01	497–500	convex: north wall −1.64 to −0.92° from east/west (concave −0.05 to +0.39°); south wall shadowed, 6.7–10.0° off; after the cut, north 3.3–5.6° off (convex)
Arm angle, cut	OP20	cut arms, centre lines; mean of the four arms	<0.01	496–500	–
Cup depth	OP10	flange above the bottom plane; median	<0.01	486–497	the flange plane is cut away at OP20
Bottom dome, cut	OP20	bottom sag at $r = 40$ mm; paraboloid fit	<0.01	474–497	–

Op.: operation measured (OP10 after drawing, OP20 after cutting). Step/F: median step between adjacent values in one series over the floor; Values: distinct values per series. Differences from the redundancy of the four sides, ranges of the series medians (Online Resource 1, Table S20); the directions used avoid them, their residual bias is unknown. Absolute values are not calibrated against a reference at the size of the part.

extrapolated. *New family*: one geometry calibrates the rules for the other (two transfers). Pooled versions of the first two add the other geometry's alternatives to the calibration set; a few-shot variant adds one to three produced alternatives of the new family. Every calibrated rule is evaluated with and without the simulation (M1/M1n, M1s/M1sn, M2/M2n, M3/M3n, M5/M5n), isolating what the simulation contributes, and the nearest produced setting is the baseline without simulation and learning. A scope , M7/M7n). A relation comprises 126 cases (18 alternatives, 7 characteristics), but the units of replication are the 18 alternatives, and the characteristics of one alternative are correlated.

The intervals uncertainty of the distances come from 1000 resamples of is described in three ways. The intervals of Table 5 resample the held-out alternatives within each geometry , each 1000 times (those held out together for a new setting individually), each resample with a block-bootstrap replicate of every true q_p , (non-overlapping blocks of 50 parts), the fitted rules held fixed; common to all rulesso that differences get paired intervals ; they hold the fitted rules fixed. A second bootstrap refits every alternative-level rule after drawing , they give paired intervals of differences, descriptive and not adjusted for the many comparisons. A refitting bootstrap redraws the three lubrication patterns of each geometry with replacement , at least two of them distinct, which keeps every case in its evidence relation (Table **??**). Its 200 resamples contain

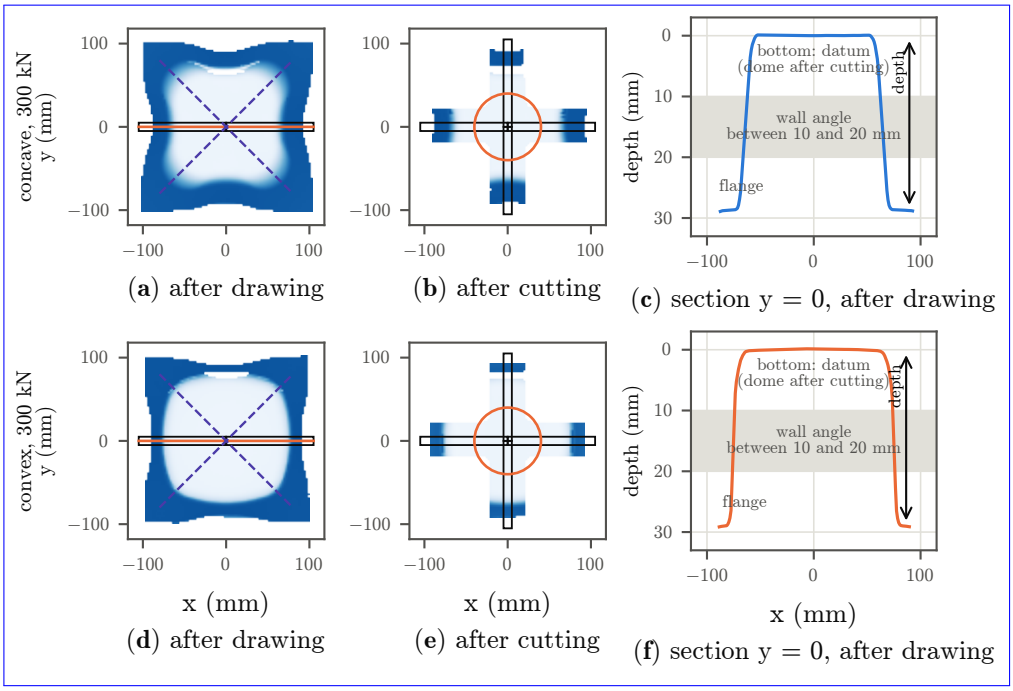


Fig. 3 Scanned parts after drawing and cutting, depth below the cup bottom (a, b, d, e), and sections (c, f); lines and boxes: directions and regions of the characteristics

~~48 of the 49 distinct configurations; in three of four draws a pattern is duplicated, so that a new variant keeps one distinct sibling and five distinct calibration alternatives, and the duplicated seriesenter the noise floor of~~ and refits every alternative-level rule, which shows the effect of losing a pattern rather than sampling uncertainty. Coverage gets cluster-bootstrap intervals over alternatives. Each truth is the ~~Gaussian processes as identical pairs. Its intervals thus show the effect of losing a pattern, not sampling uncertainty~~95th percentile of a single run, so a sensitivity analysis adds to every truth a between-run component of standard deviation τ floors, from near-replicate reproducibility up to the variation between series. The selection of rules and bands is cross-fitted between the geometries, chosen on one and evaluated on the other; like any cross-validated estimate, the distances describe the fitting procedure on this design rather than one fitted rule (Bates et al, 2024).

4.5 Computation and development record

The constants of the floor and of the requirement grid were ~~fixed~~ set before the decision results were seen, ~~as the repository history records~~which the archive cannot verify, as no timestamped snapshot was deposited at the time. The rules were not fixed in advance: M0–M5 and M3n were defined first~~;~~, and everything else was added after the first results, most of it in response to reviews of earlier versions simulated with a large language model in four rounds (M0w, Mc, M1n, NN, M2n, M5n, the grouped schemes, the exact estimator~~and the noise floor of the Gaussian processes were added after~~

the first results; an internal review of that version, simulated with a large language model, added , the noise-variance bound, M1s, M1sn, the jackknife+ intervals, the between-run noise floor and the analyses of Sections ?? and 5.5; and a second such review added M1sn, the guard bands under other guard bands with their priors and the new family scored in the produced family's floor). A fifth simulated round, of the version prepared for this journal, led to M7n, M7, Mcd, the relation-matched intervals, the decision-time strata, the per-family and out-of-sample guard bands, the costs, the between-run sensitivity, the cross-fitting, the few-shot transfer and the design-level verdicts. The comparison of rules is therefore exploratory and carries the optimism of a selection made on the evaluation data (Cawley and Talbot, 2010) (Cawley and Talbot, 2010; Varma and Simon, 2006), which the cross-fitting bounds; every variant tried is reported in the paper or in the archived results (Canseven, 2026), which , Online Resource 1 or the archive (Canseven, 2026), mapped by Table A7maps to the text. A large language model (Claude, Anthropic) assisted under the author's direction with code development, literature retrieval, data analysis, drafting and these reviews; the author designed the study and verified every analysis and reference.

5 Results

5.1 What the floor contains

In 95 % of batch pairs, two Two batches of 50 consecutive parts of one alternative differ by up to 0.051 mm in mid-side draw-in and 0.078° in wall angle in 95 % of batch pairs (Table 4);, so one floor is 0.7 to 1.7 long-term standard deviations of the parts. The floors are set by drift within the run (Fig. 4): without the time order they shrink by a factor of 2.1 to 4.5, and batches one position apart differ by 0.51–0.80 floorsand , nine apart by 1.1–1.5(averages over the two geometries). The normal model of Section 3.2 reproduces the floors to within 12 %; for subgroups of five parts, as sampled inspection would measure, it gives floors 1.1 . They vary between runs: the floor of a single run is 0.21 to 2.1 times as large (median 1.3)2.16 times the pooled floor of its geometry, and the alternative-cluster interval is wider than the batch interval. Without the warm-up of the first 150 parts the floors fall to 0.75–1.00 of the reference, which keeps the warm-up because series production starts up after every break. Independent part-to-part noise, scanner repeatability included, would produce accounts for 15–33 % of each floor, and the measurement resolution is small against the floor it except for the mid-side draw-in;, so A3 holds for repeatability and measurement resolution, but the stability of the resolution, while bias, linearity and stability remain untested.

Physical candidates for the drift are the warm-up of the tools and its effect on the lubricant, the build-up of lubricant on die and blank holder over consecutive strokes, and variation of the material and of the blank size along the stack, which enters the draw-in one to one because it is computed against the nominal 210 mm blank. Whether the drift is the process or the scanner cannot be checked settled without a reference artefact. Nor do the process signals identify the source of the drift, but two checks bear on it. No recorded process signal explains it: batch centres of press force, punch temperature, sheet thickness and oil film predict it out of fold with R^2 of −0.23 to 0.20. And the batch centres of the flange width and of the cup width at 15 mm depth,

Table 4 Within-run floor per characteristic, pooled and per geometry, with its spread over runs

Characteristic	F	Interval	Concave/convex	Single runs	No warm-up	F/σ_{LT}
Mid-side (mm)	0.051	0.042–0.061	0.050/0.052	0.36–1.62	0.99	1.0/1.4
Corner (mm)	0.046	0.032–0.053	0.053/0.030	0.27–1.62	0.95	1.4/1.2
Wavin. (mm)	0.0028	0.0021–0.0050	0.0037/0.0021	0.21–2.08	0.89	1.6/0.7
Wall (°)	0.078	0.054–0.10	0.081/0.078	0.30–1.74	0.80	1.3/0.7
Arm (°)	0.11	0.089–0.15	0.12/0.100	0.40–2.16	1.00	1.7/0.8
Depth (mm)	0.011	0.0090–0.012	0.0087/0.012	0.39–1.45	0.75	1.4/1.6
Dome (mm)	0.0070	0.0052–0.0084	0.0034/0.0082	0.42–1.61	0.93	1.2/1.6

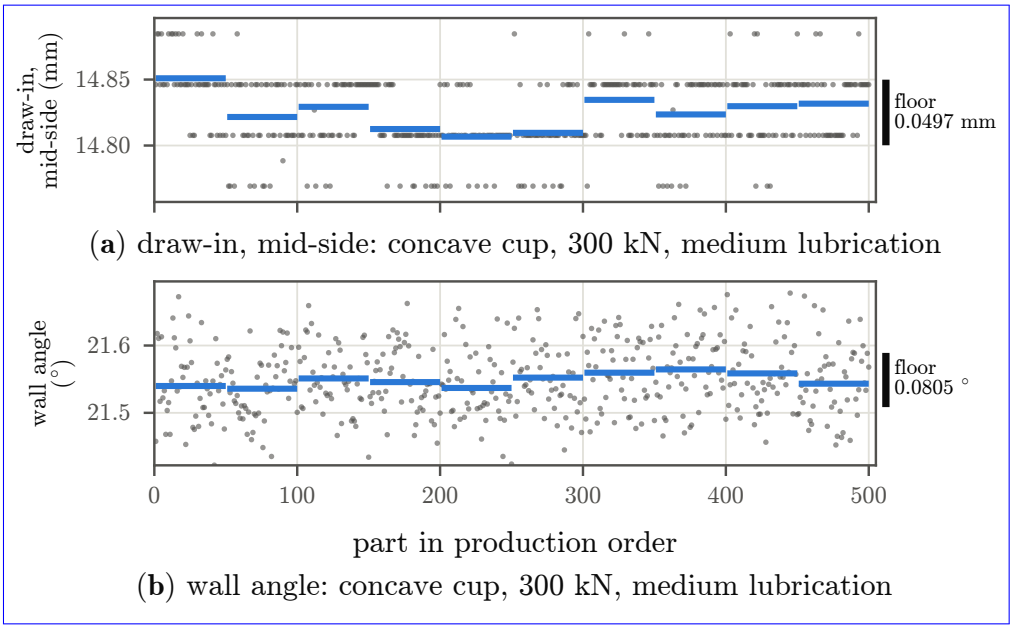
Batches of 50 consecutive parts, 95 % quantile of the difference of their 10 % trimmed means~~;~~ ~~interval from~~ . Interval: 95 % over 2000 ~~batch~~ resamples ~~. Ratios per geometry~~ of whole alternatives (~~concave/convex~~the narrower interval over resampled batches is in the archive). Single runs: floor of one run over that of its geometry, ~~classical statistics pooled~~ range over the ~~series as root mean squares~~18 runs. No warm-up: floor without the first 150 parts over the reference. σ_{LT}~~,~~ : standard deviation of the parts of a series (concave/convex); σ_b, ~~between batch means, corrected for $\sigma_w^2/50$;~~ σ_w ~~, within batches. Drift: floor over that of randomly permuted series~~and the drift in Online Resource 1, Table S20.

which punch and die largely fix, are weakly correlated within the runs ($r = -0.27$ and $+0.27$), which argues against a common lateral scale drift of the scanner; the cup width varies by 0.06–0.07 mm between batches, so it bounds such a drift only below 0.05 %, and drift in height and of the edge detection remain untestable. Variation between runs is not in the floor: the three lubrication series of one geometry and force differ by ~~up to~~ 1.2 (waviness) to 9.8 floors (dome) ~~, and a floor taken across them is 1.5 to 9.1 times the reference. Within~~ at the 95th percentile of their centre differences, lubrication effects included, whereas within a run the ~~decided statistic reproduces to about one floor (the~~ 95th percentiles of two batches of 100 parts differ by 0.92–1.49 floors in 95 % of pairs~~), so distances below about one floor are beyond what production can confirm, and a trial run, which also carries the variation between runs, confirms less still~~.

5.2 What production resolves and where the simulation dataset lies

All 63 geometry contrasts exceed the floor and blank-holder force is resolved in 105 of 126 contrasts, but lubrication only in 51 of 126, so a lubrication variant is often a near-replicate of its siblings. The minimum resolvable force change is 21–67 kN between 100 and 300 kN for most characteristics and lies beyond either force interval for the wall angle and the dome. ~~The nominal simulation misses production by far more than a floor: its median offset reaches 109 floors, its~~

The simulation dataset does not contain the produced process (Table A6): at the nominal thickness the measured centre lies within the range spanned by the friction grid in only 11 of the 42 combinations of characteristic, geometry and force. The simulated mid-side draw-in exceeds the measured one at 100 kN for every friction coefficient (by 1.8–2.0 mm at friction 0.10), reaches it at 300 kN only at the edge of the grid on the concave cup, and at 500 kN at friction 0.105 and 0.116; the corner



(**a**) draw-in, mid-side: concave cup, 300 kN, medium lubrication

(**b**) wall angle: concave cup, 300 kN, medium lubrication

Fig. 4 The 500 parts of one run in production order with the centres of its ten batches of 50 (bars) and the floor: mid-side draw-in (a) and wall angle (b)

draw-in exceeds it everywhere, by 2.6–3.5 mm. The simulated force effect on the draw-in is 2.7 to 5.1 times the measured one, and the cut arms of the concave cups bend downwards in 89–100 % of the simulations but upwards in every part~~. Part of the offset is definitional: the cup depth differs by a median 0.90 and 0.95~~, whereas the convex arm angles agree within 0.6°. Calibrating friction cannot repair this within the grid: all 72 within-family least-squares calibrations of Mc end at its upper edge (0.15), and with a discrepancy term the posterior of Mcd piles at the lower edge (0.05), where the simulated force effect is weakest. The dataset's mapping from oil film to friction implies 0.8–3.1 mm of mid-side draw-in per g/m^2 of oil, against within-run slopes of −0.01 to +0.09 mm and median slopes between the lubrication patterns of −0.17 to +0.39 mm~~, consistent with the scanned surface against the shell mid-surface, and removing this offset alone brings the decisive distance of the nominal simulation from~~ per g/m^2; noise in the oil readings attenuates the within-run slope, but the mapping is too sensitive by an order of magnitude. An envelope over the measured incoming variation instead of the whole grid halves its width but makes M5 less decisive with a sibling (24 against 7.2 floors), because through this mapping it varies with the lubrication pattern more than production does. A Gaussian-process surrogate of the simulations decides as the simulation does (109 against 108 ~~to~~ floors).

The cup depth is simulated 0.70–1.06 mm (2.5–3.7 %) deeper than measured, and the wall position at 15 mm depth, set by punch and die, 2.0–2.2 mm (2.8–3.5 %) smaller in radius. The depth offset is not definitional, since bottom and flange are seen from the same side of the sheet in both, nor due to the flange inclination, which would make the measured depth larger (Online Resource 1, Table S19); a shorter effective drawing

depth, a different tool geometry or a scale error of the scanner could each produce these offsets, which the data cannot separate. Without the depth offset the nominal simulation decides at 65 floorsinstead of 108 floors, a sensitivity only.

5.3 Decisions by evidence relation

Table 5 and Fig. 5 score the rules. The nominal simulation decides at 108 floors(101–115), erring mostly by rejecting adequate alternatives.

A new variant with a produced sibling. Every calibrated rule improves on it, and the simplest production record is the most decisive: the nearest produced setting, the mean q_{95} q_p of the two siblings, is right beyond 3.4 floors (2.0–4.5) , 0.17 mm of mid-side draw-in; the Gaussian processes decide at 7.2 and the force trend beyond 3.5, while M5 and M7n decide at 6.8–7.2 floors but are safe below one floor. Stratified by what a team knows when deciding, the nearest setting needs 1.60 floors when the two produced siblings do not differ resolvably from each other (75 cases on 17 alternatives) and 4.40 when they do (51 cases on 16), the force trend 3.05 and 4.20, and M5 6.15 and 8.90 (Online Resource 1, Table S3, with the strata of the first version, defined by the held-out alternative's own production, as a diagnostic). In physical units the nearest setting is right beyond 0.10 mm of mid-side draw-in, 0.26° of wall angle and 0.04 mm of cup depth (Table A5). One produced sibling suffices: with a single alternative at the new design's force the nearest setting decides at 3.5 floors (2.3–4.6), and further alternatives do not improve it, while they make M5 more decisive and safer (Online Resource 1, Fig. S3).

A new process setting. With every alternative at the new design's force held out, all rules lose: the force trend and the nearest produced setting decide at 8.2 and 8.5 floors , and the interval rules (M2, M2n, M3, M3n, M5, M5n) only at 13–31only at 15–19, though they are safe at 5.9–16. Interpolating in force 5–8. Interpolating is much easier than extrapolating (the nearest setting 4.7 against 9.5 floors), and the but at 300 kN, the midpoint of a balanced calibration set, the nearest setting, the force trend and the centre of M5n coincide by construction, so interpolation cannot separate rules of the mean type. The scaled simulation, extrapolating a fitted trend, falsely accepts failing alternatives as far as 164 165 floors from their limit, on the cup depth, while on the mid-side draw-in and the arm angle it is more decisive than the force trend (4.0 against 5.7 and 5.9 against 9.5 floors when extrapolating).

A new design family. Scored in the floor of the produced family, as the procedure prescribes, every rule without the simulation fails in the two transfers (130–135 floors): nothing in one family's production record describes the other. With the simulation, the bias correction decides at 33 Mcd decides at 30 floors and M5 at 35, and M3 is safe at 17 floors , M2 at 26 and M5 at 31; in the floor of the new family, which a team would not have, M2 is safe at 16, M3 at 21 and 26. Per characteristic, M5 at 28. The best rule was thus safe at about 16–17 floorsin either floor, some 0.8 mm of mid-side draw-in, but two decides at 5–10 floors for the draw-ins and the wall angle, which the forming model represents directly, but at 20–40 for depth, waviness, arm and dome. Production knowledge still carries over where a drawing nominal transfers: for the wall angle, the design angle plus the produced family's deviation from its own decides at 1.9 floors, against 7.5 for M5. Two transfers do not resolve which rule is safest: the

Table 5 Decisive and safe distances (floors) by the relation of the new design to the produced evidence

	Sibling		Interpolated		Extrapolated		New family	
Rule	δ_d/δ_s	FA/FR	δ_d/δ_s	FA/FR	δ_d/δ_s	FA/FR	δ_d/δ_s	FA/FR
M0	108	17/109	109	17/115	106	12/109	104	28/105
M1s†	4.9	4.7/4.9	19	30/19	19	165/7.9	121	125/118
M2	23/<1	<1/<1	18/2.7	3.7/2.4	18/9.9	8.7/10.0	41/26	27/9.7
M5	7.2/<1	<1/<1	19/2.8	2.4/3.1	19/8.9	8.4/9.7	35/31	33/15
interval of δ_d	6.6–8.4		18–20		18–20		31–39	
M7n‡	6.8/<1	<1/<1	7.4/3.4	2.2/3.4	15/5.9	7.5/<1	132/130	129/167
interval of δ_d	6.0–7.3		7.1–8.1		15–16		131–132	
NN†	3.4	2.8/3.4	4.7	3.1/4.7	9.5	11/5.6	130	129/168
interval of δ_d	2.0–4.5		4.3–5.1		6.6–11		129–131	
M1sn†	3.5	3.5/3.6	4.7	3.1/4.7	8.9	9.3/7.4	131	129/168
NN+RM‡	6.3/<1	<1/<1	9.6/<1	<1/<1	20/<1	1.5/<1	293/4.5	4.1/44
Trial, first 20 parts	1.4	1.5/1.2	1.4	1.5/1.2	1.4	1.5/1.2	1.4	1.5/1.2
Trial, first 50 parts	0.90	1.0/0.85	0.90	1.0/0.85	0.90	1.0/0.85	0.90	1.0/0.85

Over all seven characteristics; one number for rules that always decide; <1: below one floor. FA/FR: safe ~~distance~~ distances on the false-accept and the false-reject side~~(failing alternatives)~~. ~~Interval: bootstrap 95 % interval of the decisive distance~~ 126 cases with a sibling and ~~,~~ for a new family, ~~of the safe distance (fits fixed). 126 cases per relation (interp.:~~ 42 interpolated~~; extrap.:~~, 84 extrapolated~~)~~; a new family ~~rests on two transfers and is scored~~ in the ~~floor of the~~ produced family's floor (~~Section 3.2~~in its own floor in Online Resource 1, Table S1). ~~Pooled~~Interval: 95 % over 1000 resamples of the ~~other geometry's~~ held-out alternatives~~added to the calibration set. Below the line~~, ~~the further rules (M1sn~~fits fixed. Trial: the ~~force trend, the counterpart~~ first n parts of ~~M1s without~~ the ~~simulation) and~~design's own run, ~~as~~ a ~~robustness variant~~within-run lower bound. †, ~~M6 (~~‡: added after the ~~M5 mean with a conformal margin on standardised leave-one-out residuals)~~first results and for this version.

~~safe distance of M3 minus that of M2 lies between −16 and +7 floors in the produced family's floor and between −3 and +8 in the new family's~~.

5.4 Learning given a fair test

~~Three features of the design shape these distances. First, the sibling relation mixes replication with variation: in 58 of the 126 casesneither sibling differs resolvably from the held-out alternative, and the nearest settingis then right beyond 0.85 floors, the reproducibility of q_{95} between near-replicate runs; it needs 2.5 floors when one sibling differs resolvably (34 cases) and 4.9 when both do (34 cases), where~~ The Gaussian processes fitted by maximum marginal likelihood reduce to the baselines in this design (Table A3). For a new setting the force length scale of M5n sits at its lower bound in 68–79 % of the fits and its noise variance at its bound in every fit, and its centre lies within 0.01 floor of the calibration mean in 93–95 % of the cases; with a sibling it lies a median 0.28 floor from the nearest setting. The trend GP, specified for this regime, reduces to the force trend ~~needs 4.5 and M5 9.7. Second, the extrapolation is confounded with stroke speed: the nearest settingdecides at 11 floors at 100 kN, where the press also ran slower, against 4.9 at 500~~instead: its centre lies a median 0.33–0.36 floor from it for a new setting, its force length scale stays near the prior's

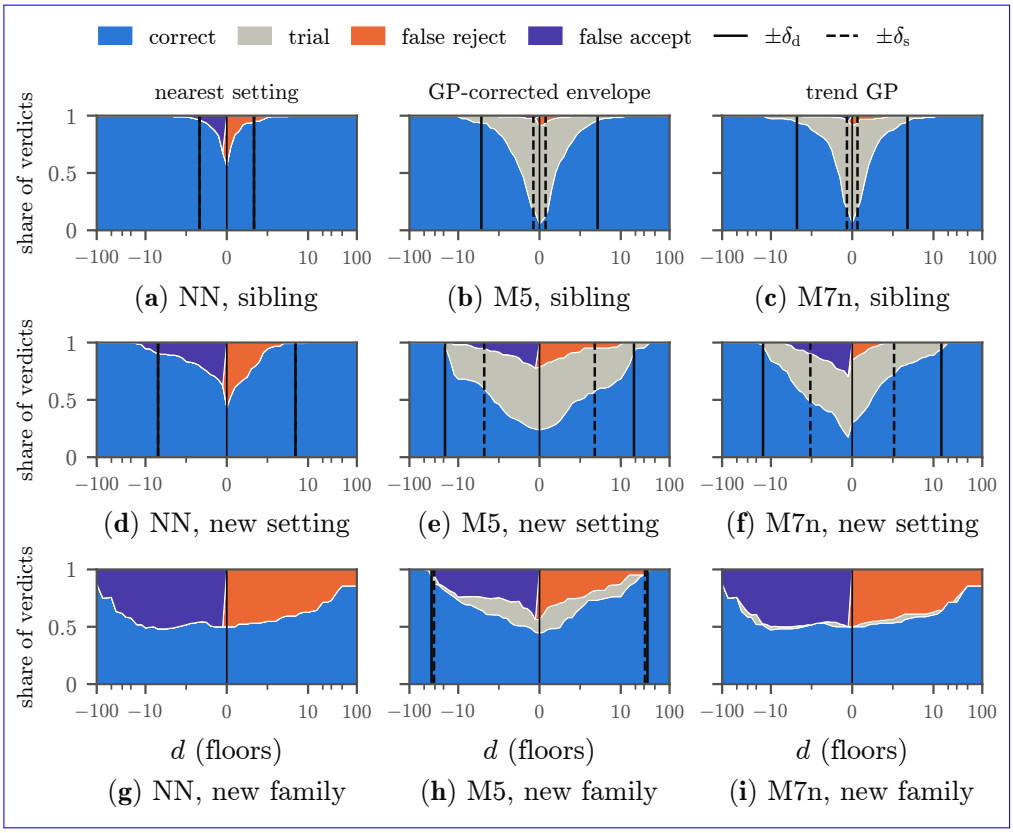


Fig. 5 Verdict shares against the requirement distance d (symmetric logarithmic axis, linear within ±10 floors; 126 cases per panel; a new family in the produced family's floor)

200 kN~~(the force trend at 8.9 at both). Taken together, the nearest setting decided at up to about 5 floors whenever the new design differed resolvably and force and speed did not change together, though each stratum has 34 to 58 cases and each distance rests on a handful of verdicts. Third, the other family's record does not help with a produced sibling: pooling it makes most rules less decisive (M5 from 7.2 to 11 floors), though it raises M5's coverage from 86 to 90 %.~~

~~The relation therefore does not govern decision fitness in general. Over the eleven calibrated rules and three relations, the relation explains 67 % of the variation of the log decisive distance and the rule 6 % (69~~ , which two force levels cannot inform, and ~~6 % in the new family's own floor), but only because rules without the simulation fail~~ its between-run nugget, 0.4–0.5 floors, is three to four times the sampling error of the truths. It is more decisive than M5n for a new ~~family by construction; over the two relations within a family, the rule explains 68 % and the relation 15 % (71 and 15 % with M1sn). Pooled over strata, the best attainable distance grows with novelty: 3.4~~ setting (14.5 against 17.2 floors; paired difference −2.7, −5.6 to −1.1) and as safe, but less decisive than the nearest setting in every relation (by 3.5 floors with a ~~produced sibling , 8.2~~ sibling and 6 for a new setting~~, 33 for a new family.~~

Pairing each calibrated rule with its counterpart without the simulation isolates what the simulation adds as used. Added as an offset, it adds nothing with a produced sibling and degrades two rules: M5 decides where M5n does (difference 0.0 floors, −0.4 to +1.1), while M2 and M1 decide 3.9 (+0.5 to +7.4) and 6.2 floors (+4.6 to +9.7) further out than M2n and M1n, and M1 13.5 further out). With the simulation in its mean (M7) it gets worse for a new setting (28 floors), because the simulated force effect is too large. Rescaled, itdoes no better: within a geometry the nominal simulation is a function of the force, and the straight line in force (M1sn) decides 1.4 floors closer than the scaled simulation trend enters it. The archive's study of part-level boosting (regularised, flexible, ridge, quantile loss, inner selection) finds no setting closer than 11.2 floors with a sibling (+0.65 to +3.0) and 11 closer and 13.1 for a new setting(+5.3 to +13.8), in every resample and refit configuration; the 4.2 floors that the scaled simulation gains over the median of the produced alternatives with a sibling come from the force level. Only for a new family is the simulation decisive, by 92 to 98 floors as an offset and 10 rescaled, and even there production knowledge carries over where a drawing nominal transfers: for the wall angle, the design angle plus the produced family's deviation from its own decides at 1.9 floors, against 7.5 .

Prediction and interval separate (Table A4). A relation-matched interval borrowed from the other family makes even the nearest setting safe for a new setting (safe distance <1 floor, against 6.8 for M5 (for the arm angle and the dome, whose nominal is zero in both families, this baseline is M1n, at 44 and 27 floors). A Gaussian-process surrogate of the simulations over force, friction and thickness, with a leave-one-out root-mean-square error below 2 floors for 12 of the 14 characteristics and geometries, decides as the simulation does (109 and 5.2 for M7n) at the decisive distance of the learned intervals (19.5 against 108 floors as M0, 15 against 15 as M1 with a sibling).

Learning adds intervals rather than accuracy. Used as point rules, the centres of the M518.7 and 14.5 floors), M5n and M3n intervals decide at 3.3, 3.1 covers 88 % of the truths interpolating and 93 % extrapolating, against 71 and 3.7 floors with a produced sibling, as close as the nearest setting (Table ??46 % for M5 and 52 and 56 % for M7n. By the interval score (Gneiting and Raftery, 2007) the relation-matched intervals are the best for a new setting (12–14 interpolating and 19–24 extrapolating, against 14–98 and 41–147 for the rules' own intervals; Online Resource 1, Table S4). With a sibling the Gaussian-process intervals cover 85–86 % of the true q_{95} against a nominal 90 %, but their noise variance sits at its lower bound, the variance between the calibration series of one setting, in 97–99model-based intervals (M5, M5n, M7n, M7, Mcd) cover 83–86 % of these fits and in every new-setting and new-family fit, so this coverage comes from the quasi-replicate series rather than from the learner; the largest-residual margin covers 89(cluster intervals 0.71–0.94), compatible with their nominal 90 %, and the jackknife+ intervals 96 % (of M3) and 8996 % (M3n) , above their guarantee of 7/9. For a new setting the calibrated intervals cover 43–550.93–0.98) against a guarantee of 0.78; the conformal margin of M6, computed on sibling-type residuals, covers 93 % (M2n and M5n 93with a sibling at a cost of ten floors of decisiveness against M5 (17 against 7.2) but 61 % interpolating), for extrapolating. For a new family the Gaussian processes at most 12 %: trees do not extrapolate, two force levels identify at most a linear trend, and in the median new-setting fit the length scale of the force sits at

Table 6 Guard bands of step 6 (floors), their out-of-sample share correct and the trial rate

	Sibling				Interpolated				Extrapolated			
Rule	g	g_5	OOS	T	g	g_5	OOS	T	g	g_5	OOS	T
NN†	0.25	2.0	95	2	2.0	4.25	95	18	7.0	14.25	94	55
M1sn†	0.75	2.75	95	7	2.0	4.25	95	18	6.0	8.5	95	48
M2	0	0	99	54	0.75	2.75	95	53	none	none	–	100
M5	0	0	99	23	0.5	2.75	96	54	none	none	–	100
M7n‡	0	6.75	98	19	0.75	3.75	95	27	3.25	6.75	95	56
NN+RM‡	0	0.5	99	28	0	0	99	42	0	5.25	97	72

g, g_5: guard band under the reference prior and under the release-like prior (requirements within ±5 floors); none: no band up to 20 floors reaches 95 %. OOS: share correct (%) among decided verdicts with the band estimated leaving each alternative out within its family. T: share of verdicts sent to trial (%), reference prior. No rule qualifies for a new family; bands per family, out of sample and under other priors in Online Resource 1, Tables S7–S10.

~~its lower bound.~~ no interval covers well except at widths that send every design to trial. With one produced alternative of the new family, its offset to the other family's record decides at 8.9 floors in the new family's floor and the family's own record at 10.5; with two or three, its own nearest setting decides at 7.7 and 5.9 floors, while a two-task Gaussian process with a free inter-family correlation is safe at 1.3–1.6 floors but decides only at 13–17.

~~A single produced sibling decides (Fig. ??): with one alternative at the new design's force, the bias correction, the envelope rule and the nearest setting coincide and decide at 3.5 floors(2.3–4.6) without a wrong verdict at 10 floors . Further alternatives do not improve the nearest setting; they make the bias correction worse (12–18 floors), the envelope rule safer but less decisive,~~

5.5 Guard bands

Step 5 turns the margins into guard bands (Table 6; Online Resource 1, Fig. S4). Under the reference prior the nearest setting needs 0.25 floors with a sibling, 2.0 interpolating and 7.0 extrapolating, and sends 2, 18 and 55 % of the verdicts to trial; M2 and ~~M5, shown from three alternatives because a Gaussian process fits its hyperparameters to them, safer and more decisive (13 to 7.2 floors). Without a sibling , bracketing the new force buys safety but not decisiveness: the envelope rule and~~ M5 ~~are safe at 2.7–4.8 floors but decide only at 15–25, against 4.7–6.0 for the nearest setting, and extrapolation stays unsafe at every budget. With calibration series of 50, 100 or 250 parts instead of 500, no distance within a family moves by more than~~ need no band with a sibling and less than one floor interpolating, but send 23–54 % of the verdicts to trial, and they do not qualify for an extrapolated setting. Estimated per family, as step 5 prescribes, the bands differ between the geometries (the nearest setting 1.5 ~~floors,~~ and ~~for a new family by at most 4 in its own floor (Table ??): rules can be calibrated on short runs, but the floors and the held-out truths came from the full series, and whether truths from short runs suffice to qualify the rules was not tested.~~

~~What a designer observes for a single verdict is the margin between the predicted interval and the requirement,~~ 2.5 floors interpolating, 9.5 and 5.75 extrapolating), and

its value as evidence depends on the relation (Fig. ??): with a produced sibling at least 95M2 and M5 qualify for an extrapolated setting on the convex cup only; moved to the concave cup, their bands give only 84 and 83 % of the decided verdictsof correct decided verdicts. Out of sample the bands hold: leaving one alternative out keeps the share of correct decided verdicts at 0.94–0.99 for every rule and relation, and leaving one force cell out at 0.93–0.95 for the interval rules are correct at every margin, for a new setting the share grows with the margin, and for a new family nearest setting and the force trend, but at 0.83 and 0.81 for M2 and M5 are right in at most 79when extrapolating. The 95 % of their decided verdicts.

Step 5 turns this into guard bands (Table ??). Under the reference prior the interval rules need none is an average over characteristics: with a sibling and the nearest setting 0.25 floors; for an interpolated setting the nearest setting needs 2.0 floors and then decides at 6.7 floors without trials at 10 floors, whereas M2 and M5 need 0.75 and 0.5 floors but send 31 and 40is right in 89 % of its decided verdicts on the dome, 98.5 % to trial; for an extrapolated setting it needs 7.0 floors and sends a quarter to trial. M0 and M0w never qualify, nor do M1 and Mc with a sibling, M1s for an interpolated setting, M1, M1s, M2, M5 and Mc for an extrapolated one, or any rule for a new familyon the waviness and 92 % on the cut part.

These The bands belong to the prior as much as to the rules. A prior concentrated near the truth, where release-level requirements lie (the grid within ±5 floors), raises Under the release-like prior the band of the nearest setting grows to 2.0 floors with a sibling, 4.25 interpolating and 14.25 extrapolating(8.0, 5.0 and 14.75 within ±3); a uniform prior within ±20 floors lowers them to 0, 0.25 and 3.5 floors and qualifies M2 and M5 for an extrapolated setting (6.0 and 5.0 floors), and one within ±50 floors qualifies M2, M3 and M5 for a new family (6.25, 6.5 and 15 floors). That every new-family design goes to trial thus follows from it decides only 63, 32 and 2 % of the verdicts; leaving a force cell out, its share correct drops to 0.72 when extrapolating. Under the reference prior and the 20-floor capno rule qualifies for a new family, as the practice of trying out every new die would have it. The bands are chosen on the evaluation data, which makes the trial rates optimistic. The : Mcd reaches 95 % on one transfer with a band of 18 floors, but that band gives 73 % on the other (under a uniform prior within ±50 floors M2, M3 and M5 qualify). The applicability guards, reported as diagnostics, refuse indiscriminately: the range guard refuses exactly the extrapolated designs(84 of the 126 new-setting cases), and , and 96 % of its refusals at requirements 10 floors from the truth 96 % of its refusals would have been right for the nearest settingand 72 % for M5 (novelty guard 96 and 73 %).

A worked example. A tryout engineer has to decide whether the concave cup at 300 kN with medium lubrication, a new setting, can be released without a trial run, with the six alternatives at 100 and 500 kN produced and

5.6 Costs, trials and release-level requirements

Pricing the verdicts by Eq. (2) with a requirement, chosen for illustration, that 95 % of the parts have a mid-side draw-in, by which tryout sets the blank-holder force , of at most 15.30 mm. The floor is 0.050 mm, the relation is interpolation and no guard fires. Alone, the nominal simulation predicts 15.66 mm and fails the design . The nearest

produced setting , the mean of false reject at half the cost of a false accept (Fig. 6), the six alternatives at the neighbouring forces, predicts 14.99production record and the Gaussian processes cost about the same with a sibling while trials are cheap, and the nearest setting is the cheapest rule once a trial costs a tenth of a false accept or more; for a new setting the force trend or the nearest setting is the cheapest at every trial cost; and for a new family trying every design is the cheapest until a trial costs about a tenth of a false accept, beyond which M2 and then M5 are. The cost-minimising band of the nearest setting falls from 5 to 0 floors with a sibling and from 15 to 0 when extrapolating as the trial cost rises from 0.01 to 0.5 of a false accept; the 95 mm, a margin of 6.2 floors% bands of step 5 correspond to trials costing a tenth to a quarter of a false accept, more than its guard band of 2.0 floors (5.0 under the grid within ±3 floors), so step 6 returns meets. Widened by their guard bands , M2, M5 a new force on an existing tool costs, so cost-optimal bands would be wider. A trial is not error-free either: scored as a rule, a trial of the first 20 or 50 parts of the design's own run decides at 1.35 and M5n return 14.41–15.410.90 floors, 14.23–15.61 and 14.66–15.33 mm and send the design to trial . The 500 parts had a 95th percentile of 14.88 mm, 8.4 floors below the limit. The case is typical, since at 8.5 floorsabove the truth step 6 with the nearest setting is right in all 42 interpolated cases, but its guard band was estimated on data that include ita lower bound, since a trial on another day also carries the variation between runs.

Upper limits at which an alternative has a performance index of 1.0, 1.33, 1.67 or 2.0 lie a median 1.0, 1.7, 2.5 and 3.1 1.03, 1.75, 2.46 and 3.14 floors above its 95th percentile; up to . A limit at an index of 1.33they lie inside every decisive distance except a near-replicate sibling's (0.85 floors). The test is one-sided by construction: every alternative meets these limits, so a verdict can only be right, a false reject or a trial, and a rule biased towards meets scores well. At an index of 1.33 the shares of right verdicts, false rejects and trials are, with a produced sibling and for a new setting, 91/9/0 and 65/35/0 % for , a recommended minimum for existing processes and the lower end of the range in which an initial process study may be acceptable after a customer review, therefore lies inside every attainable distance except that of the nearest setting , 44/2/53 and 32/16/52 % for M5, and 81/19/0 and 79/21/0 % for the scaled simulation, which falsely accepts failing alternatives elsewhere; for a new family no rule is right in more than 54 %. Release-level requirements are thus when the produced siblings do not differ resolvably from each other (1.60 floors), which it exceeds by only 0.15 floor: release-level requirements are decided at the design stage only with a near-replicate produced sibling, and then by the production record. General angular tolerances of ISO 2768-1 (ISO, 1989) give a coarser scenario: only 32 of its 108 decisions lie within 5 floorsof the limit, 6 of them on failing alternatives, and a cost comparison inherits this coarseness. With a false reject at half the cost of a false accept, the cheapest rule is (i) with a produced sibling , the nearest setting, the scaled simulation and if at all.

5.7 Sensitivity, selection and robustness

A between-run component added to every truth lengthens the distances but keeps their order (Online Resource 1, Table S12): with $\tau = 3$ floors, about the largest variation

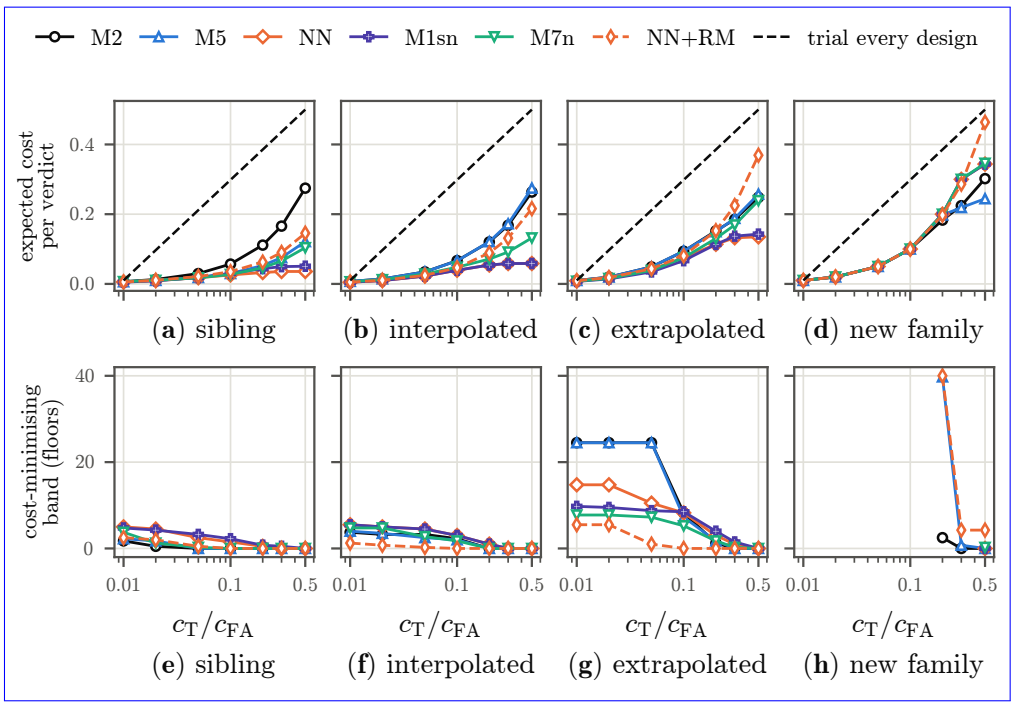


Fig. 6 Expected cost per verdict with the cost-minimising band (a–d) and that band (e–h) against the cost of a trial; reference prior, $c_{FR} = 0.5\,c_{FA}$

between series, the nearest setting needs 5.8 floors with a sibling and 10 extrapolating, M5 9.3 and 20, a production-record rule (nearest setting, force trend or median) is the most decisive within the family in each of 200 draws, and the band of the nearest setting with a sibling grows from 0.25 to 2.9 floors. Selected on one geometry and evaluated on the other (Online Resource 1, Table S13), the most decisive rule is the nearest setting with a sibling (2.0 and 3.6 floors), the force trend ~~, tied at zero cost; (ii) for a new setting,~~ or the median interpolating (4.2–5.8) and the force trend ~~at every trial cost, by three false rejects of~~ or the nearest setting ~~among 108 decisions; and (iii)~~extrapolating (8.9–11); for a new family ~~, a trial of every design while a trial costs at most a tenth of a false accept, the envelope rule at a fifth and M5 beyond.~~

~~Table ?? repeats the analysis under variants of the data, constants and model specifications. Adjusting for punch temperature changes no calibrated distance by more than 2.6 floors. Dropping the warm-up of the first 150 parts shrinks the floors~~ the rule selected on one transfer decides at 32–33 floors on the other, and ~~so lengthens the distances, and floors taken between series shorten them. Other floor protocols rescale~~ the safest pre-specified rule, M3, is safe at 17–18. Paired intervals between point rules span about ±2 floors with a sibling and when extrapolating, so smaller differences are not resolved by this design.

Requiring all seven characteristics of a design to meet (Online Resource 1, Table S14) raises the decisive distances ~~by 0.60 to 1.42, and the Gaussian-process specifications move them~~ of the production-record rules by at

most ~~1.2 floors and the safe distances by at most 2.1. In every variant that includes them, the most decisive rule~~ 1.8 floors within a family ~~is~~ (the nearest setting ~~or the force trend, and with a produced siblingthe nearest setting (tied once) . The refitting bootstrap widens the intervals of the learned rules most~~ (5.1 floors with a sibling, the force trend 9.5 extrapolating) but those of M5 ~~4.0–11 floors with a sibling, the nearest setting 2.3–4.6), yet in all 200 resamples (48 configurations)~~ by up to 16, and to 39 floors for M5 for a new family. Lower limits on the 5th percentile, calibration and truths from the first 20 or 50 parts, and the decided statistic $\bar{m} + 4\sigma$ (an index of 1.33) leave the nearest setting ~~is more decisive than M5 and M5n,~~ within 0.4 floor of its reference distance with a sibling and ~~for a new setting alike, and the force trend than the scaled simulation (by 1.35–3.6 and 8.8–12 floors); point estimates at the edge of their refit intervals (M1s with a sibling at 4.9 floors, 4.9–7.3, and the safe distances of M2 and M5) reflect what losing a pattern does~~within 1.2 when extrapolating, and a production-record rule the most decisive within the family (Online Resource 1, Table S2), as do the robustness variants of data, constants and specifications; other floor protocols rescale the distances by 0.60 to 1.42, and floors recomputed without the held-out alternative's own series move the distances of the nearest setting and the force trend by at most 0.25 floors and those of the other main rules by at most 1.4.

6 Discussion

6.1 What the evaluation establishes

~~Five findings answer the research questions. Two~~ Two findings follow from the definitions and hold wherever the framework is applied: the floor puts every rule and characteristic on a common production-referenced scale, though not on a common scale of nonconforming fractions, and as a within-run quantity it bounds the variation of series production from below (RQ1); and an interval rule trades decisiveness for safety, which the two distances make explicit~~, while its distribution-free intervals are guaranteed their level only where the calibration alternatives are exchangeable with the new design. Three~~ . The others are observations on ~~this dataset~~one laboratory process, with every alternative produced once and a generic simulation dataset, and hypotheses for confirmation~~: the best~~ . The attainable distance grows with the novelty of the design~~, from~~ : a production-record rule committed to in advance decided at 3.4 floors with a ~~produced sibling (the nearest setting 0.85 for near-replicates~~sibling (1.6 when the two produced siblings did not differ resolvably from each other, 4.4 when they did), ~~4.9 for resolvable siblings) to 8.2~~ 8.5 for a new setting (~~the force trend; by stratum the nearest setting needed~~ 4.7 ~~interpolated and 4.9 extrapolated to 500 kN, the force trend 8.9 to 100 kN, where the nearest setting needed 11) and 33~~ interpolating, 9.5 extrapolating) and 30 floors at best for a new family, ~~while~~ and within a family the choice of rule ~~matters~~ mattered more than the relation, also among the pre-specified rules (RQ2)~~; production evidence buys safety before decisiveness, and interval rules held their level with a produced sibling but not when extrapolating or for a new family; and with this simulator and~~ . For this simulation dataset and for Gaussian processes and boosting fitted to six to nine ~~produced alternativesat two or~~

Table 7 Guidance for design-stage manufacturability decisions, with its basis

Situation	Guidance	Basis
From the framework (prescriptive; usefulness not evaluated)		
Before relying on a predictor	Measure the floor on consecutive production of the family with a stated protocol; report σ_b, σ_w, its lag dependence and the floors of single runs; treat it as a lower bound of series variation.	framework
Qualifying a rule	Evaluate it by grouped cross-validation for the evidence relation of the coming designs, per family, with siblings stratified by whether they differ from each other, and per characteristic.	framework
Choosing a rule	Compare it with the nearest produced setting and with its own version without the simulation, on both distances and by expected cost at the team's trial cost.	framework
Deciding a single design	Derive the guard band for the requirements the team expects, validate it out of sample, and apply it to the observable margin; a margin inside it means a trial.	framework
Observed in this study (one process, 18 alternatives produced once, 2 geometries; not general)		
New variant with a produced sibling	the nearest produced setting decided beyond 3.4 floors (1.6 when the produced siblings did not differ resolvably from each other); no learned rule was more decisive	18 alternatives
New process setting	production record 8.2–8.5 floors, interval rules 15–19; intervals matched to the relation made it safe	6 force cells
New family	only rules with the (generic) simulation decided, at 30 floors and beyond; none qualified for single verdicts	two transfers
Release-level requirements	within about 2 floors of the 95th percentile: decided at best with a near-replicate sibling, otherwise by trial	18 alternatives

~~three force levels~~alternatives, the simulation ~~, as an offset or rescaled, contributed only~~ contributed little within a family, helping single characteristics when extrapolating in force, and mattered across families, for the characteristics it models directly; the learners added no decisiveness, and ~~M5, M5n and M3n predicted as well as the nearest produced setting with a produced sibling while adding abstention~~ what made rules safe for new settings was an interval calibrated on the relation (RQ3). Qualification by relation also exposed a dangerous extrapolation: the scaled simulation, decisive with a sibling, falsely accepted failing alternatives up to 165 floors from their limit when extrapolating in force.

6.2 Implications for practice

~~As a planning heuristic (Table 7), the expected margin between a requirement and the predicted 95th percentile can be compared with the safe distance of the best rule qualified for the relation; the~~ For a process planner or quality engineer the results say three things. Within a family the production record answers most design-stage questions if it is ~~smaller, a trial or more production evidence has to be planned, and the decision itself needs the guard band, because the safe distance is defined on the true margin. Release-level requirements make this the usual case, as the practice of a production trial run for a process change expects: the rules decide reliably where a trial is cheapest, a new force on an existing tool being a short press run, and none does near~~ indexed by how the coming design relates to it: a sibling at the same setting settles a

requirement a few floors away, a new force within the produced range almost as well, and an extrapolated force or a new family needs a trial unless the requirement is far. Under the reference prior, of 100 verdicts on new variants with a sibling the nearest setting with its band sends 2 to trial and gets at least 93 of the other 98 right; of 100 on extrapolated settings it sends 55 to trial. And near release-level ~~limits where a trial is dearest, for a new family that may need a new tool. The most decisive rule is arguably~~ limits nothing replaced a trial without a nearly identical produced sibling, so the value of design-stage prediction lies in the many decisions far from the limits rather than in the few close ones. For a developer of an AI-based manufacturability tool the lesson is methodological: a learned model has to be compared with a production-record baseline and with its own version without the simulation, scored by evidence relation in a unit that production defines, its intervals calibrated on cases of the same relation and shown to its user with a guard band. The nearest setting is also the most transparent ~~: the nearest produced setting points~~ rule, pointing to the produced alternatives whose record it averages~~. The variants that steps 1 to 5 need come from process development and tryout, whose short series of several settings support the sibling and new-setting relations, and from a family's production history across part numbers, which supports the new-family relation; production part approval, whose initial process study covers the released setting, supplies the floor but not the variants~~, and so the natural default where a learned rule shows no advantage.

6.3 Simulation and machine learning in this regime

Within a design family the production record carried the decision ~~,~~ even against a ~~rescaled simulation. The simulated force trend of the two draw-ins was 2.7 to 5.1~~ calibrated or rescaled simulation, but the simulation here is a generic dataset that does not contain the produced process: its force trend is two to five times too large, ~~and calibrating the friction coefficient did not repair it, which points to the friction law and the blank-holder model rather than to a parameter. A multi-task model cannot help a family with no produced alternative, because the correlation between families cannot be estimated without its data; in the pooled scopes the Gaussian process with a 0/1 geometry input is a restricted intrinsic coregionalisation model (equal variances, one positive correlation between the families, shared length scales), which improved coverage but not decisiveness. These findings concern one simulator of low fidelity, used through offsets and one scale, and learners~~ its friction calibration is censored at an edge of the grid with or without a discrepancy, and its oil-to-friction mapping is too sensitive. A process-calibrated simulation, with friction depending on pressure (Hol et al, 2012), a hardening model fit for springback (Wagoner et al, 2013) and elastic tools (Pilthammar et al, 2018), might contribute more; the per-characteristic results show where it already helps, for the draw-ins and the arm angle when extrapolating and for the characteristics it models directly in a new family. The learners failed for a reason the framework exposes: with six to nine ~~produced~~ alternatives at two or three force levels ~~. For evaluating AI-based DFM support the lesson is methodological: a learned model should be compared with a production-record baseline, scored by evidence relation in a unit that production defines, and shown to its user with a guard band. A study with design teams could test two hypotheses~~

on reliance (Lee and See, 2004), with cases of known production outcome: designers shown the guard-banded verdict accept a smaller share of wrong verdicts within the safe distance than designers shown the verdict alone, at an equal rate of right acceptances; and, as the same AI assistance helped some teams and hindered others (Zhang et al, 2021), the guard band narrows the spread of that share between teams.

For variant and platform design (Pahl et al, 2007; Simpson et al, 2006) and the capability databases that serve them (Tata and Thornton, 1999; Thornton, 2004), the results argue for indexing production records by their relation to the coming design rather than for a more sophisticated model on top. The safe distance is the part of a margin that covers predictive uncertainty, as distinct from the part that absorbs change (Eckert and Isaksson, 2017; Eckert et al, 2019). The growth of the decisive distance, pooled over strata, from about 3 to 8 and over 30 floors says for which overlaps of development (Krishnan et al, 1997; Terwiesch et al, 2002) preliminary manufacturability information can be released, the new-family safe distance, some 0.8 mm of draw-in, how far a set-based design (Sobek et al, 1999) can narrow a feasible set before production evidence exists, and the distances and trial rates when a test is cheaper than a decision (Thomke and Bell, 2001; Salado and Kannan, 2018). The evaluation shows structural validity, that the metrics discriminate between rules and relations on real data (Seepersad et al, 2006); performance validity would require better decisions with the frameworka flexible model can identify at most a linear trend, and a well-specified one then becomes that trend. Nonlinear multi-fidelity models (Perdikaris et al, 2017), physics-informed learning (Karniadakis et al, 2021), conformalised quantile regression on the parts (Romano et al, 2019) and multi-task models over more families (Bonilla et al, 2008) are the next candidates, to be scored in the same way.

6.4 Reuse for other processes and AI-based tools: a proposal

The framework needs several produced variants of a design family whose relations span those of the coming designs, a series of consecutive parts or replicated batches of one design per variant, a design-stage predictor for every variant , and characteristics measured identically on parts and predictions; here rules calibrated on about nine produced alternatives per family and 500-part series gave ten batches of 50 parts per variant scored within 1.5 floors of those calibrated on full series , against truths and floors from the full series. Attribute outcomes such as splits need a requirement on a rate, which the framework does not yet cover. Other predictors need three adaptationsparts for the floor, one produced sibling sufficed for the nearest setting, and truths from the first 20 or 50 parts moved its distance with a sibling by less than half a floor. The extensions below are untested. A classifier with a fixed threshold does not take the requirement as input, so its operating characteristic is estimated by binning test cases by their true margin, not by the exact estimator of Section 3.4, unless the requirement is made an input; a probabilistic classifier needs two thresholds to return a trialwhich needs a continuous, production-referenced outcome for every test design that CAD-based manufacturability datasets usually lack. A language-model check may return verdicts that are not is scored on a grid of requirements with repeated queries, reporting model and version, query date, decoding settings and prompt paraphrases, treating refusals

Table 8 Proposed reporting checklist for evaluating a design-stage decision rule against production

Item	Why it matters	In this paper
Floor and its protocol	every distance is in this unit	B, α, σ_b, σ_w, lag, single runs (Table 4)
Measurement of the characteristics	biases enter absolute comparisons	Table 3, Section 4.3
Relations, cases and replication units	alternatives, not cases, replicate	per relation, 18 alternatives
Both distances, false-accept side	decisiveness and safety differ	Table 5
Baselines	production record, no simulation	NN, M1sn; every pair with and without
Intervals: source and level	coverage is a property of the construction	Tables 2, A4
Per-characteristic results	pooled distances hide the worst	Table A5
Guard band, prior, validation	the deployed part	per family, out of sample (Table 6)
Costs and trial rates	deployment is a cost question	Fig. 6
Development record	selection optimism	Section 4.5, cross-fitting
Query protocol (language models)	verdicts vary between queries	proposal (Section 6.4)

and hedged answers as trials, checking that its verdicts are monotone in the requirement and ~~that vary between queries, so κ and ω are computed on a requirement grid with repeated queries, and~~ testing for contamination, since public datasets and the papers describing them may be in its training data. A requirement on a rate, such as the share of ~~non-monotone verdict sequences is reported. For~~ split or wrinkled parts, is scored in the same way once each alternative's rate is estimated from its series, with a floor over batches of rates; for continuous design spaces the relation becomes a distance from the produced designs in descriptor space~~or the position relative to their hull, and each stratum needs about as many cases as a relation here: with 126 cases, some 240 verdicts, the 95 % threshold already rests on about a dozen. A generative tool's manufacturability check is scored. A minimal report lists the floor with its protocol, variance components and lag dependence; decisive and safe distancesby relation, with refit intervals and one-sided values; coverage and half-width of interval rules, and the source of their noise variance;~~. Table 8 is a proposed reporting checklist, modelled on model cards (Mitchell et al, 2019) and TRIPOD+AI (Collins et al, 2024) ; the scoring is released as a small documented function, separate from the pipeline, that takes intervals, truths and floors and returns distances, guard bands and trial rates (Canseven, 2026). An attempt on open powder-bed fusion data (Leirmo, 2021) failed for lack of replicated batches within a build: a floor within a build would need at least ten replicated anchors of one design per build and several builds per setting.

6.5 Deployment

In use, a step-6 verdict would be shown with its margin in floors and in the unit of the ~~nearest-produced-setting~~ characteristic, the relation on which it rests and the produced alternatives behind it, and ~~no-simulation baselines; the guard bands with their prior,~~

the trial rates and the performance of the guards; for language-model tools, the prompt and the query protocol. Table ??, an untested proposal, maps these requirements onto other processes; distances in floors are comparable within a protocol, not across processes, since a floor between builds, cavities or offset intervals is a between-unit quantity (here the floor between series is 1.5 a trial verdict with the requirement distance at which the rule would decide. A qualification has to be maintained: the realised errors of step-6 verdicts can be tracked against later production on a control chart of decision outcomes, and a rule re-qualified when its share of wrong decided verdicts exceeds 5 % beyond what the number of verdicts explains, when the floor of new runs leaves the range of the single-run floors, or when the die is reworked. The evidence has a cost, several 500-part series per family before any rule qualifies, which the results bound from below: one produced sibling settles most verdicts with a sibling, and one produced alternative of a new family brings its decisive distance from 28 to 9.1 times that within a run). An attempt on open powder bed fusion data of PA12 (Leirmo, 2021) failed on the second requirement: orientation classes mixed orientations in a batch, eight identical anchors per build were too few for a floor within a build, and three builds give three differences between builds9 floors in its own floor. Whether teams decide better with the framework is an empirical question: a study with cases of known production outcome could test whether designers shown the guard-banded verdict accept fewer wrong verdicts within the safe distance than designers shown the verdict alone, at an equal rate of right acceptances (Lee and See, 2004), and whether the band narrows the spread of that share between teams (Zhang et al, 2021).

6.6 Threats to validity

The evaluation covers one material, one press and two geometries, with relations within a family from a 3×3 factorial in which lubrication is mostly not resolved; the procedure is general, the numbers are not. The new family rests on two transfers between geometries that differ in three features at once, and the intervals of its distances hold the two fits fixed. Each alternative was produced once, so the floor covers drift within a run but not between days, coils or tool states, the reference q_{95} reference q_p is that of one run , and the order and dates of the series are unknown; between-series variation bounds the missing component at 1.2–9.8 floors, and scanner drift cannot be separated the variation between days, coils and tool states is missing; the sensitivity analysis bounds its effect but cannot replace replicated runs. The floor does not separate scanner drift from process drift. The extrapolation to 100 kN is confounded with stroke speed, which the simulation omits, and absolute values are uncalibrated. The simulation dataset was not calibrated to the process, so the findings on simulation concern this dataset. The requirements are one-sided limits on the 95th percentile of a characteristic averaged over sidesdimensional characteristics, below the conformance of series release. Several rules, the grouped schemes, the guard bands and their prior were added or chosen after earlier ; attribute outcomes such as splits and wrinkles are not covered; and the verdicts are marginal per characteristic, a design-level verdict being an extension. The guard band was estimated pooled over characteristics, its prior is a reference rather than a team's, and the costs are assumed. Rules, strata, bands and priors were partly chosen after results had been seen and are evaluated on the same data, so the

comparison between rules carries selection optimism (Cawley and Talbot, 2010); ; the cross-fitting bounds the optimism but does not remove it, and a single analyst carried out the analysis, with code and data open for replication.

7 Conclusions

Design-stage manufacturability decisions can be evaluated against production on a scale production defines: the decisive and safe distances in floors tell how close to a requirement a rule decides and how close it can be relied on not to mislead, and a guard band derived and validated for the requirements a team expects turns them into a rule for single decisions. On 18 deep-drawn alternatives with matched simulations, the best , priced by the costs of errors and trials. In an exploratory application to one laboratory deep-drawing process, with alternatives produced once and a generic simulation dataset, the attainable distance grew with novelty: the novelty of the design: the nearest produced setting, committed to in advance, decided at 3.4 floors with a produced sibling (the nearest setting 0.85 for near-replicates, 4.9 for resolvable ones), 8.2 and 8.5 for a new process setting(the force trend; the nearest setting 4.7 interpolated and 4.9 extrapolated to 500 kN, the force trend 8.9 to 100 kN, with a stroke-speed change), and no rule safe closer than 16–17 decided closer than 30 floors for a new family , in either family's floor. Within a family the choice of rule mattered more than the relation; requirements at a performance index of 1.33 lay inside every decisive distance except a near-replicate's and need a trial without a produced sibling ; and in this small-data regime the simulation as used, offset or rescaled, contributed only across families, while learned 90 % intervals covered 85–96 % of truths with a producedsibling, under 50 % extrapolating or for a new family(the pre-specified M5 at 35). Release-level requirements lay within these distances, so they needed a trial unless a near-replicate sibling had been produced.

For design practice, the production record carried the decision within a family, which argues for indexing such records by their relation to the coming design rather than for a more elaborate model; across families only rules using the simulation carried the change of geometry, and none decided near release-level limits. For AI-based manufacturability support, the framework offers a standard of evaluation rather than a verdict on machine learning: a tool is scored by evidence relation in floors against a production-record baseline and reported with the checklist of Section 6.4evaluation separated what the learners were credited with: Gaussian processes and boosting fitted to six to nine alternatives reproduced the production record, and intervals calibrated on the same evidence relation, not learning, made it safe for new settings.

The evidence is one process and two geometries, and the comparison of rules is exploratory. Four extensions follow: series from several days, coils and tool states; a process-calibrated simulation; families with continuous geometric descriptors; and a confirmatory test of the frozen procedure on other data; and a study of whether design teams decide better with it. Within a design family, the baseline that a learned manufacturability check has to beat is a production record indexed by its relation to the coming design.

Appendix A Notation, further rules and results, and computation details

Table A1 summarises the notation~~of Section 3~~, Table A2 defines and scores the further rules, Table ~~?? gives the distances under the robustness variants~~A3 gives the fitted Gaussian processes, Table ~~?? the coverage, width and centre of the interval rules~~A4 the predictors with relation-matched intervals, Table A5 the distances per characteristic, and Table ~~?? the procedure's decision rule by relation~~A6 the simulation against the measurement. Table A7 traces every other number quoted in the text to the script that computes it and the result file that holds it in the archived release (Canseven, 2026), in which `scripts/run_all.sh` runs the scripts in order and `make_tables.py` and `figs.py` write every table and figure~~from the result files~~; Online Resource 1 holds the further tables (S1–S20) and figures.

Computation details. Batches need at least 80 % valid values. M5 and M5n are Gaussian-process regressions (constant times anisotropic squared-exponential kernel plus white noise, normalised targets, hyperparameters by maximum marginal likelihood without hyperpriors, three restarts, length scales in $[0.1, 100]$) on a geometry indicator, the force in 100 kN and the lubrication rank; the lower bound of the noise variance ~~,~~is the larger of the mean sampling variance of the calibration alternatives' ~~q_{95}~~ q_p and the pooled variance between their series of one geometry and force~~, is expressed on the normalised scale~~. M7n and M7 work in pooled floors: the mean basis is an intercept, the force (or, for M7, the nominal simulation) and the lubrication rank, plus the geometry indicator when both families calibrate; the coefficients have a flat prior and are integrated out (restricted likelihood); the hyperparameters are maximum a posteriori under log-normal priors with medians of 200 kN and one pattern step for the length scales, two floors for the GP and one floor for the nugget standard deviation, and log-scale standard deviations of 1, 1.5 and 1; the predictive variance adds the nugget and the mean sampling variance of the calibration q_p. Mcd has a uniform prior over the 11 friction values of the grid, a GP discrepancy with a constant mean and the same priors, a posterior from the two draw-ins, and a 90 % interval from the posterior mixture. NN takes the mean ~~q_{95}~~ q_p at the nearest force of the family, both neighbours when equally near; M1sn fits ~~$q_{95} = a + b$~~ $q_p = a + b$ force by least squares. Mc calibrates, per lubrication pattern, the friction coefficient whose simulated draw-ins are closest to the calibration centres, without a discrepancy. M3 and M3n use histogram gradient boosting (depth 3, 200 iterations, rate 0.08) on geometry, force, lubrication, sheet thickness and oil film, with 500 incoming conditions drawn from calibration parts of the same pattern~~; their jackknife~~, and jackknife+ ~~interval takes the leave-one-out predictions for the new alternative, shifted by the median leave-one-out residual, minus and plus the absolute residuals about that median, with its bounds at the extreme order statistics when n is too small for the 0.9 quantiles~~intervals. Guard bands lie on a grid of 0.25 floors. ~~The refitting bootstrap draws the three lubrication patterns of each geometry with replacement 200 times, at least two of them distinct, and does not restrict the noise floor to distinct series.~~ Software: Python 3.11 with NumPy, pandas, SciPy, scikit-learn (Pedregosa et al, 2011) and Matplotlib.

Table A1 Notation and terms

Symbol, term	Meaning
a, c, $q_p(a, c)$	design–process alternative, characteristic, p-quantile ($p = 0.95$) of its parts
R, d	requirement (upper limit on c or $\lvert c\rvert$), d floors from the truth: $R = q_p + dF_c$
$[L_r, U_r]$, V_r	interval of rule r for q_p; verdict meets, fails or trial (Eq. 1)
c_{FA}, c_{FR}, c_{T}	costs of a false accept, a false reject and a trial (Eq. 2)
B, m, F_c	batch size (50); batch centre (10 % trimmed mean); within-run floor (Eq. 3)
σ_{b}, σ_{w}, σ_{LT}	standard deviations between batch means, within batches, and of the parts of a series
ESR	effect-to-scatter ratio $\lvert\bar{m}_a - \bar{m}_b\rvert / F_c$; resolvable when at least one
$\kappa(\delta)$, $\omega(\delta)$	shares of correct and wrong verdicts among the feasible verdicts at $\lvert d\rvert = \delta$
δ_{d}, δ_{s}	decisive distance ($\kappa \geq 0.95$ beyond it) and safe distance ($\omega \leq 0.05$ beyond it)
FA side	distance for failing alternatives only, where an error is a false accept
g	guard band: observable margin beyond which ≥95 % of decided verdicts were correct, under a stated prior of requirement distances
Evidence relation	sibling (same setting), new setting (interpolated, extrapolated), new family
Decision-time stratum	siblings resolvable from each other or not, known before deciding
P+RM	predictor P with a relation-matched split-conformal interval borrowed from the other family
τ	standard deviation (floors) of a between-run component added to every truth

Table A2 The further rules and their decisive/safe distances (floors) by relation

Rule	Prediction of q_p	Sibling	Interp.	Extrap.	New family
M1	M0 plus the median offset of the calibration alternatives	15	11	25	33
M1n†	median q_p of the calibration alternatives	9.1	4.8	12	131
M2n†	M1n with the largest-residual margin	19/<1	13/<1	16/9.1	133/128
M5n†	GP of q_p over the descriptors, ML-II, noise-variance bound	7.2/<1	16/<1	18/8.6	133/128
M7‡	M7n with the nominal simulation in the mean (AR(1) multi-fidelity)	7.1/<1	22/16	28/17	140/104
Mc†	friction per pattern fitted to the draw-ins, least squares, plus offset	27	14	40	43
Mcd‡	friction calibrated with a GP discrepancy; posterior mixture	7.2/<1	22/1.6	24/5.8	30/19
M0w†	range of the simulation over thickness and friction	119/94	119/94	119/77	117/79
M3	matched simulation plus boosted discrepancy, parts; jackknife+	23/<1	29/13	33/17	40/17
M3n	boosted model of the characteristic, parts; jackknife+	11/<1	15/7.0	13/7.8	135/126
M6†	M5 mean with a conformal margin on standardised residuals	17/<1	47/<1	56/8.1	35/28

~~Rules refitted for every variant; empty cells:~~ Pairs with and without the ~~variant does not affect~~ simulation: M1/M1n, M2/M2n, M3/M3n, M5/M5n and M7/M7n, as M1s/M1sn (Table 2); M3n is M4 in the ~~rule~~code; M6 is a robustness variant. A new family in ~~its own floor (in~~ the produced family's floor~~in Table 5~~). ~~The floor between series contains the lubrication effect~~ Pooled scopes and ~~, for a new variant, the series that NN averages, which makes it close to circular there~~intervals in Online Resource 1, Table S1.~~Warm-up~~

Table A3 Fitted Gaussian processes by relation: hyperparameters and where their centres lie

Relation	Rule	Cases	ℓ_F	At bound	Noise	Δmean	≤0.01	ΔNN	ΔM1sn	HW
Sibling	M5	126	0.13	45	1.00	2.6	0	0.27	0.92	2.2
	M5n	126	1.76	22	1.00	2.1	20	0.28	0.88	2.3
	M7n	126	1.43	–	3.6	2.6	0	0.40	1.0	1.6
Interpolated	M5	14	0.10	64	1.00	4.1	0	4.1	4.1	6.4
	M5n	14	0.10	79	1.00	0	95	0	0	5.8
	M7n	14	1.92	–	4.0	0.36	2	0.36	0.36	2.0
Extrapolated	M5	28	0.10	54	1.00	6.8	0	6.1	4.9	4.6
	M5n	28	0.10	68	1.00	0	93	1.3	3.9	3.7
	M7n	28	1.95	–	3.1	4.2	0	2.9	0.33	2.8
New family	M5	14	0.21	43	1.00	24	0	21	22	1.9
	M5n	14	1.77	21	1.00	1.9	13	0.22	0.66	2.0
	M7n	14	1.51	–	3.7	2.2	1	0.37	0.83	1.2

ℓ_F: ~~first 150 parts~~median force length scale (100 kN). ~~Calibration~~At bound: ~~calibration q_{95} from the first n parts, truths and floors from the full series~~fits with ℓ_F at its lower bound (%). ~~Response surface~~Noise: ~~simulations from a quadratic fit~~ fitted noise over ~~thickness and friction; other GP kernels and descriptors move~~ its bound (M5~~by at most 0.4 floors. Unit: the q_{95} floor~~, ~~95 % quantile of the difference between~~ M5n) or nugget over the ~~q_{95} of two batches of 100 parts. Refit: 95 % intervals~~ sampling error of the ~~decisive and safe distances over 200 draws of each geometry's lubrication patterns with replacement~~ truths (~~Section 4.4~~M7n), median.
~~Cov~~Δmean, ΔNN, ΔM1sn: ~~share~~ median distance (floors) of the centre from the calibration mean, NN and M1sn; ≤0.01: cases ~~whose true q_{95} lies in~~ within 0.01 floor of the ~~interval~~ calibration mean (%~~; nominal 90~~). HW: median half-width (floors).~~Ctr~~

Table A4 Point predictors with a relation-matched interval, against the rules' own intervals

	Sibling		Interpolated		Extrapolated		New family	
Predictor + interval	δ_d/δ_s	Cov	δ_d/δ_s	Cov	δ_d/δ_s	Cov	δ_d/δ_s	Cov
NN+RM	6.3/<1	84	9.6/<1	88	20/<1	93	293/4.5	86
M1sn+RM	7.1/<1	88	9.6/<1	88	18/<1	88	293/4.3	86
M1s+RM	11/<1	90	43/6.9	86	31/4.8	86	243/<1	93
M5n+RM	6.1/<1	88	9.6/<1	88	24/<1	89	293/4.5	86
M5+RM	6.0/<1	86	21/<1	93	26/2.2	85	52/<1	91
M3n+RM	8.1/<1	88	21/<1	86	20/<1	93	292/4.8	86
M7n+RM	6.5/<1	91	11/<1	90	18/<1	89	293/5.1	86
M7+RM	6.7/<1	89	45/6.4	86	31/<1	89	248/<1	93
The rules with their own intervals								
M2	23/<1	89	18/2.7	71	18/9.9	44	41/26	47
M3	23/<1	96	29/13	43	33/17	43	40/17	40
M5	7.2/<1	86	19/2.8	71	19/8.9	46	35/31	12
M7n	6.8/<1	85	7.4/3.4	52	15/5.9	56	132/130	0

P+RM: ~~decisive distance~~ the prediction of P (for interval rules the interval centre~~used as a point rule (floors~~) ~~. A new family in the floor of~~ with the ~~produced family. The GP noise variance sits at its lower bound in 97 and 99~~90 % split-conformal quantile of ~~the M5 and M5n fits with a sibling and in every new-setting and new-family fit.~~
~~g: guard band~~ P's absolute errors (floors) ~~under~~ over the ~~reference prior (Section 3.6); no applicability guard is applied; δ_d/δ_s: distances~~ cases of the ~~rule with its interval widened by g; T_{10}~~same relation in the other family (sibling 63, ~~T_{20}~~interpolated 21, extrapolated 42, new family 63). Cov: ~~share~~ coverage of ~~verdicts sent to trial~~ the true q_p (%)~~at requirements 10 and 20 floors from the truth. None: no band up to 20 floors reaches 95 %, so the procedure sends every design to trial~~; ~~so also M0~~ cluster intervals and ~~M0w~~ interval scores in ~~every relation, Mc with a sibling and for an extrapolated setting (for an interpolated one $g = 18$), and every rule for a~~ Online Resource 1, Table S4. A new family ~~, scored~~ in the produced family's floor.

Table A5 Decisive distance per characteristic in floors and, in brackets, in its unit

	NN			M1sn	M1s	M5	
Characteristic	Sibling	Interp.	Extrap.	Extrap.	Extrap.	New family	P_{pk}
Mid-side (mm)	2.0 (0.099)	3.8 (0.19)	6.5 (0.32)	5.7 (0.28)	4.0 (0.20)	5.5 (0.27)	1.3
Corner (mm)	4.5 (0.13)	1.9 (0.058)	6.7 (0.23)	2.8 (0.083)	2.9 (0.100)	9.9 (0.31)	2.5
Wavin. (mm)	<1 (<0.0028)	4.8 (0.014)	11 (0.040)	9.3 (0.027)	21 (0.077)	22 (0.047)	0.9
Wall (°)	3.4 (0.26)	<1 (<0.078)	1.9 (0.15)	1.8 (0.14)	2.0 (0.16)	7.5 (0.58)	1.7
Arm (°)	2.8 (0.28)	5.9 (0.59)	5.4 (0.53)	9.5 (0.94)	5.9 (0.69)	39 (3.9)	1.6
Depth (mm)	3.3 (0.039)	4.4 (0.038)	15 (0.13)	9.9 (0.086)	165 (1.4)	20 (0.20)	2.4
Dome (mm)	7.0 (0.038)	5.3 (0.044)	4.3 (0.020)	3.0 (0.020)	15 (0.056)	40 (0.21)	4.0

18 cases per characteristic with a sibling and for a new family, 6 interpolated, 12 extrapolated; units through the pooled floor of the characteristic; a new family in the produced family's floor. P_{pk}: median performance index of a requirement at the decisive distance of NN with a sibling. All rules and the safe distances in Online Resource 1, Table S15.

Table A6 The simulation dataset against the measurement, over the six geometry–force cells

Characteristic	Measured	Sim. − meas.	In floors	Inside	Closest μ	x–y	Roughness
Mid-side (mm)	14.73–16.08	0.12–2.01	2–38	2	0.11–0.15	0.1–0.2	0.1
Corner (mm)	4.62–10.00	2.59–3.48	49–116	0	0.15	–	0.1–0.2
Wavin. (mm)	0.052–0.103	−0.052 to +0.011	−14 to +5	3	0.05–0.14	–	0.4–4.0
Wall (°)	11.43–21.60	−2.14 to −0.37	−27 to −5	0	0.05–0.15	1.8–2.3	1.7–3.1
Arm (°)	−4.95 to +0.76	−4.64 to +0.42	−40 to +4	3	0.05–0.11	0.5–1.1	0.9
Depth (mm)	28.29–28.82	0.71–1.06	58–116	0	0.05–0.15	–	0.7–0.8
Dome (mm)	0.030–0.116	−0.087 to +0.104	−11 to +30	3	0.08–0.15	–	2.4–9.8

Measured: range of the cells' centres (signed). Sim. − meas.: simulation at 0.99 mm and friction 0.10 minus the measured centre, in the unit and in floors. Inside: cells whose measured centre lies within the simulated range over the friction grid (of 6). Closest μ: grid friction nearest the measurement. x–y, Roughness: standard deviation of the difference between the two directions of the quarter model and roughness along the friction grid (floors), the extraction noise of the simulation. Per cell in Online Resource 1, Table S18.

Table A7 Where the numbers quoted in the text come from: scripts and result files (`results/*.csv`)

Section	Results	Script: result files
3.4, 4.1, 4.3	failing-side weight, run metadata, scan redundancy and biases, resolution	panel.py: panel_failing_weight, panel_runs, panel_resolution_steps; measurement.py: meas_scan; simcheck.py: meas_characteristics, meas_cut_walls
4.2	simulation noise of the characteristics	measurement.py: meas_sim
5.1	time order, lag profile, single-run floors, warm-up, components, tooling reference, in-line drift	alternatives.py: alt_floor; sensitivity.py: sens_drift; panel.py: panel_variogram, panel_floor_protocol; measurement.py: meas_floor; simcheck.py: meas_run_floors, meas_tooling_reference; inline.py: inline_drift
5.2	resolvable contrasts, validation, friction fits, oil mapping, depth offset, envelope, force effect, arm sign, surrogate	alternatives.py: alt_effects, alt_mrc; simcheck.py: sim_validation, sim_mc_friction, sim_oil_mapping, sim_depth_offset, sim_envelope_variant; learners.py: learn_mcd_posterior; panel.py: panel_force_effect, panel_arm_sign, panel_m0_split; design_space.py: ds_surrogate_rule
5.3	distances, paired differences, strata, per characteristic, units	decisions.py: dec_resolution, dec_paired; learners.py: learn_resolution, learn_source_floor, learn_paired; panel.py: panel_source_floor; qualify.py: qual_strata, qual_per_characteristic
5.4	GP diagnostics, crossing, coverage, interval score, M6, tuning study, few-shot transfer	learners.py: learn_gp_diagnostics, learn_fewshot; qualify.py: qual_coverage, qual_m6_coverage; decisions.py: dec_gp; tuning.py: tune_decisions
5.5	guard bands per family, out of sample, priors, per characteristic	qualify.py: qual_guard_family, qual_guard_oos, qual_guard_prior_width, qual_guard_characteristic; panel.py: panel_step6, panel_guard_priors
5.6	costs, trial, capability-anchored limits	qualify.py: qual_costs, qual_trial; panel.py: panel_capability
5.7	between-run sensitivity, cross-fit, resolvable difference, design level, variants, floors without the held-out series, robustness, budget	qualify.py: qual_between_run, qual_crossfit, qual_resolvable_difference, qual_design_level, qual_variants, qual_decomposition, qual_floor_loao; robustness.py: rob_decisions, rob_refit; budget.py: budget_design
6.4	scoring function; PA12 attempt	opchar.py (self-check against dec_resolution); case2_pa12.py: case2_floor

M3n is named M4 in the released code.

Supplementary information. Online Resource 1 holds the further tables (S1–S20) and figures referred to in the text: all rules with their intervals, robustness and sensitivity variants, coverage per characteristic and stratum, the step-6 decision rule, guard bands per family, out of sample and under other priors, costs, cross-fitting, few-shot transfer, design-level verdicts, the full validation of the simulation and the redundancy of the scans.

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Declarations

Funding. No specific funding was received for this work.

Competing interests. The author declares no competing interests.

Ethics approval and consent. Not applicable.

Data availability. All data are public. RDDAC: doi:10.18419/DARUS-5589 (version 2.0); DDACS: doi:10.18419/DARUS-4801 (version 3.0); both licensed CC BY 4.0. The extracted per-part and per-simulation feature tables and all result files are archived with the code (Canseven, 2026).

Code availability. The complete analysis pipeline, which reproduces every number in this paper from the public data, is archived with the feature tables and result files ~~of this version~~ on Zenodo (Canseven, 2026); Table A7 maps the numbers to its scripts and files, and `scripts/opchar.py` is the scoring function for other datasets. A working copy is at https://github.com/htcanseven/Claude (directory `scripts/`).

Author contributions. H.T.C. conceived the method, designed and carried out the analysis, and wrote the paper.

Use of generative AI. A large language model (Claude, Anthropic) ~~assisted~~ was used under the author's direction to write and debug analysis code, retrieve and check literature, run analyses and draft text. It was also used to simulate reviews of earlier versions of the manuscript in five rounds, acting as referees and editor; most rules and analyses added after the first results were added in response to these simulated reviews, among them the nearest-setting baseline NN, M1s, ~~as~~ M1sn, M7n, M7, Mcd, the jackknife+ and relation-matched intervals, the guard bands with their priors and their validation, the decision-time strata, the costs, the between-run sensitivity and the cross-fitting (Section 4.5~~describes~~). None of these reviews is a review by a journal. The author designed the study, verified ~~all analyses~~every analysis against the archived results, checked every reference against its published record, and takes full responsibility for the content; the language model is not an author. All figures are produced by the released code; no AI-generated images are used.

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